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Google loses appeal against €4.1 b European Union anti-trust penalty

COSTLY DEFEAT. European Court of Justice upholds 2022 ruling to fine US giant for abusing Android’s market power

Bloomberg

Google lost its long-running fight against a €4.1 billion (\$4.7 billion) European Union antitrust fine after the bloc’s top judges said regulators were right to punish the US giant for abusing Android’s market power.

The European Court of Justice ruled on Thursday that Google’s earlier defeat against a European Commission penalty should stand. The decision is legally binding and marks a significant win for the Brussels-based regulator, which has been fighting Google through EU courts since the fine was first levied in 2018.

ABUSE OF POSITION

“The appeal brought by Google and its parent company Alphabet against the judgment of the General Court is dismissed, thereby confirming the penalty imposed for Google Search’s abuse of a dominant position in the context of the Android operating system,” the court said in a statement.

The decision is a constraint on the Android business model — which has provided free software in exchange for conditions imposed on mobile phone manufacturers. Such contracts provoked the ire of the Commission in 2018, when the watchdog accused Alphabet Inc’s Google of three separate types of illegal behaviour that helped cement the dominance of its search engine, accompanying the order with the then-record fine. The decision also paves the way for a wave of potential lawsuits from victims of Google’s behaviour.

Google said the ruling “fails to recognise our significant investment to ensure Android remains open, interoperable and free. In any event, we adapted our agreements to comply with the initial decision back in 2018, and we remain focused on continued innovation and openness for our users, partners and developers.”

FairSearch, a group of complainants that brought the case to the commission in 2013, called the ruling “an



TECH CURBS. Judgment reinforces stricter antitrust enforcement against platform dominance under EU digital regulations REUTERS

important victory in Europe’s highest court against Google’s anti-competitive conduct in mobile markets.”

PLAY STORE

Commission spokesman Ricardo Cardoso said the regulator would “carefully assess” the details of the court win. In its decision to fine Google, the Commission said it was illegally forcing handset makers to pre-install the Google Search app and the Chrome browser as a condition for licensing its Play Store — the market-

place for Android apps. Secondly, the EU said Google made payments to some large manufacturers and operators on condition that they exclusively pre-installed the Google Search app. Lastly, the EU said Google prevented manufacturers wishing to pre-install apps from running alternative versions of Android not approved by Google.

In a September 2022 ruling at the EU’s lower General Court, judges upheld the vast majority of the commission’s arguments, but cut the fine from €4.3 billion after

finding that regulators hadn’t provided enough evidence for specific abuses.

The Android case was a key element in erstwhile EU competition chief Margrethe Vestager’s effort to crack down on the growing power of Silicon Valley.

Since Vestager was replaced by Spanish official Teresa Ribera in 2024, Google has continued to face EU scrutiny — including under the bloc’s powerful Digital Markets Act, introduced to prevent Big Tech from leveraging market power before traditional antitrust rules kick in.

Earlier this year, Google was told to lift technical barriers to rival AI search assistants on Android and provide key data to other search engine providers. Separately, it faces penalties under the DMA over allegations it unfairly favours in-house services and for preventing app developers from steering consumers to offers outside of its Play Store. It’s also being probed over concerns it unfairly demotes certain news results.

Now, Telegram, Signal get govt notices on username feature

Our Bureau
New Delhi

After sending notice to instant messaging app WhatsApp, the Centre on Thursday also sent notices to Telegram and Signal, raising questions on their existing username feature, and asking how the platforms are addressing concerns relating to fraud and impersonation.

Sources said that in the notice to Telegram, the government has asked the platform why it should be allowed to retain the username feature, adding that similar action could be taken with all such platforms that have ‘username’ feature.

Meanwhile, WhatsApp on Thursday said that username reservation relating to well-known public figures is restricted only to their legitimate account owners, and any claims that people are reserving popular or well-known usernames are “false”.

OPTIONAL FEATURE

Through an FAQ, WhatsApp said usernames will be optional, cannot be searched by strangers and users can add an additional ‘username key’



requiring both the username and the key before someone can contact them.

“A few more things to keep in mind... People are making false claims about reserving popular or well-known usernames — this isn’t true, only the legitimate account owners are able to reserve well-known public-figure names,” it said.

India is a key market for WhatsApp, and the go-to messaging platform has over 500 million users here.

On Wednesday, the Centre issued a notice to its parent company Meta over the planned feature on WhatsApp, citing concerns that it could materially increase online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams and impersonation attacks. It directed the platform to pause the feature until con-

sultations on the issue are completed “to the satisfaction of the government”.

Meanwhile, Zoho Founder Sridhar Vembu announced in a tweet on Thursday that the company will “be disabling the username-based account feature in Arattai to comply with the regulatory change. We have had the feature even before WhatsApp. So the writing on the wall was clear.”

ALREADY TAKEN

WhatsApp’s proposed username feature had also raised a red flag among experts and users, who believe the new offering could trigger a surge in financial fraud.

However, WhatsApp, through a statement, defended the feature, citing built-in safeguards to prevent scams and impersonations and protect users.

“To protect against impersonation, we’ve held the highest-profile names — think public figures, government entities, celebrities, verified Meta accounts — so they can only ever be claimed by their legitimate owners and lookalike derivatives of known names are held as well,” a WhatsApp spokesperson said.

PILGRIMS ARRIVE



HOLY TREK. Pilgrims started gathering at the Baltal Base Camp, where they will spend the night before proceeding to the Amarnath cave shrine, in Baltal, 110 km from Srinagar. The annual yatra to the shrine began on Thursday under unprecedented security in Jammu & Kashmir IMRAN NISSAR

New NBFC norms: Sans strategic rejig, Tata Sons may have to list

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The RBI’s updated regulatory framework for non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) does not materially alter the position of Tata Sons, which may still be required to list unless it undertakes a significant strategic restructuring.

The updated Reserve Bank of India (Non-Banking Financial Companies-Registration, Exemptions and Framework for Scale-Based Regulation) Directions, 2025, define ‘public funds’ as those raised either directly or indirectly. However, it excludes funds raised through instruments that are compulsorily convertible into equity shares within five years from the date of issue.

According to Nazneen Ichhaporia, Partner at ANB Legal, the provision relating to ‘public funds’ is largely clarificatory and does not introduce any new implications beyond what was already contemplated under the earlier framework. “The original definition already covered funds raised both directly and indirectly through associates or group entities, which is how the term would typically be interpreted in legal parlance. For the Tata Group, nothing changes. Under the new guidelines, Tata Sons would continue to be classified in the Upper Layer. Any relief from the listing requirement would depend on the RBI granting an exemption, which appears unlikely,” she said. As things stand, Tata Sons’ classification as an Up-



per-Layer NBFC (NBFC-UL) could eventually require it to pursue public listing unless it undertakes a significant strategic restructuring.

The updated directions stipulate that NBFCs with asset size of ₹1 lakh crore or more will be categorised as Upper Layer entities, and subjected to enhanced regulatory oversight. By this metric, Tata Sons, the principal investment holding company of the Tata Group, exceeds the threshold and falls within the RBI’s most strin-

gent supervisory framework.

5-YEAR WINDOW

A key feature of the revised framework is the mandatory five-year period during which an NBFC classified as Upper Layer must continue to comply with enhanced regulations. Even if the company’s asset size falls below the threshold in subsequent years, it will remain in the Upper Layer for at least five years. Under the normal route, an NBFC can exit the category only if it does not meet the classification criteria for 5 consecutive years.

This provision effectively prevents companies from temporarily shrinking their balance sheets to avoid stricter regulations, including listing-related requirements applicable to certain Upper Layer NBFCs.

However, the RBI has provided a limited avenue for an earlier exit. The directions state that an NBFC-UL may move out of the enhanced regulatory framework before completing the five-year period if the change results from a voluntary strategic restructuring undertaken under a board-approved policy.

Such restructuring could involve a fundamental realignment of business operations or the corporate structure. The central bank has clarified that this relaxation will not be available where the reduction in operations stems from financial stress, deteriorating asset quality or other adverse business conditions. In such cases, the company will continue to remain under enhanced regulatory supervision.

‘RDI Fund has seen a good response with TDB allocating ₹2,000 cr to 22 start-ups’

bl.interview

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

The ₹1 lakh crore Research, Development, and Innovation (RDI) Fund has seen a tremendous response with the Technology Development Board committing around ₹2,000 crore, its entire allocation, to 22 selected start-ups, and the selection of Second Level Fund Managers to be completed by end of this month, Abhay Karandikar, Member (S&T), NITI Aayog, said in a chat. Karandikar also spoke about the strategic rollout of the new Prime Minister Research Chair Scheme, which will

offer high-value research grants to attract top-tier global scientific talent to India’s R&D labs and select higher education institutions. On sovereign AI, the technocrat said that Sarvam AI, BharatGen, and other indigenous models are all scaling, and in the next six months to one year, there will be more push and differentiation in these models, improving their adoption.

Edited excerpts:

What is the status of the deployment of the ₹1 lakh crore Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund? We are in the process of selecting the Second Level

Fund Managers. The Technology Development Board (TDB) and BIRAC were already nominated as SLFMs.

The TDB already issued a call for proposals and has seen an overwhelming response. It has selected 22 start-ups, and the total commitment of these 22 start-ups has been about ₹2,000 crore, which is the entire fund allocated to TDB and that is already exhausted. Now, they have asked for additional funding from the RDI Fund. We have also received about 150 applications for the selection of SLFMs, and by the end of July, I think the alternate investment funds will also be onboarded from this.

“

Selection of second-level fund managers on track to be completed by end of this month

ABHAY KARANDIKAR
Member(S&T), NITI Aayog



A new Prime Minister’s Research Chair Scheme has been announced to attract global research talent to India. How effective do you think it will be?

It is a transformative scheme for attracting talent to India. Under this scheme, scient-

ists from abroad can work in select higher education institutions and also national R&D labs, in certain priority areas that have been defined. These priority areas were defined keeping in mind the national priority and the fact that we need to attract global talent in those areas. It’s less about attracting people with

money but more to attract key talent in priority areas. For many of the senior scientists who have had their careers in the US and have made their money, the personal salary is not important. But when they come here, they would need some research funding and grants, so that will be fulfilled by the grants offered under this scheme. The host institutions have opened applications, and once we receive the application and do the initial processing, then an Apex Committee chaired by the Principal Scientific Advisor will do the final selection.

Do you think the US government’s recent

actions on AI are a wake-up call for India?

As a government, I think we are promoting indigenous foundational models, large language models, and AI application development already. It is not because of any recent actions of the US; it has long been the government’s vision of developing the technology indigenously, not just in AI, but in other areas also, like in quantum and other deep tech sectors. Even the ₹1-lakh-crore RDI fund was established for this reason.

Sarvam AI and BharatGen are all scaling now, and what is really needed now is their adoption across sectors. Now, in the next six months

to one year, there will be a push for adopting these indigenous foundational models.

At a policy level, what can further aid the adoption of indigenous models?

I don’t think it is about just telling people to use the alternative models. The models have an edge when you consider the 22 Indian languages [they support], and this gives them an edge for specific applications. For example, for applications in the agriculture sector, giving crop advisory in local languages, etc.

So, these models have that differentiation, and it will lead to their diffusion in a faster way.

Health-conscious consumers beat the heat with dairy beverages

Brands are reporting soaring sales of buttermilk, lassi, flavoured milk and protein drinks

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Amidst a scorching summer, packaged dairy-based beverages like buttermilk, lassi, haldi doodh and flavoured milk are seeing high double-digit growth.

This surge in demand comes as health-conscious consumers increasingly prioritise wellness and look for functional ways to boost their daily protein intake.

SALES SOAR

Jayen Mehta, MD, GCMMF (Amul), told *businessline*: “We have a large portfolio of 120 SKUs ranging from Haldi Doodh to Single Origin Coffee. The beverage portfolio has grown 40-45 per cent this summer sea-



Protein-rich beverages are gaining popularity as consumers prioritise nutrition and refreshing summer drink options

son. Category growth has been higher. For instance, buttermilk sales rose 60 per cent month-on-month in June, while the Amul protein range has been growing at 100 per cent.”

Mehta said the strategic focus on expanding distribution and ramping up marketing investments through associations with nine IPL

teams built up a positive momentum for the brand during the summer season. Jayatheertha Chary, Managing Director, Mother Dairy, pointed out that factors such as rising temperatures, increasing preference for hygienic and healthier packaged products, and better access through online and offline

channels had been supporting the growing demand for dairy-based beverages.

“Our dairy beverages portfolio witnessed strong double-digit growth this summer, led by robust demand across categories. For instance, flavoured milk registered growth of over 50 per cent, while our Probiotic Chaach category rose upwards of 40 per cent, reflecting strong consumer preference for refreshing, value-added dairy beverages,” he added.

PRICE ADVANTAGE

For Parle Agro, its dairy beverage brand Smooth registered a “high double-digit” growth.

Nadia Chauhan, Joint Managing Director and

CMO, Parle Agro, said, “Smooth has delivered another strong year of growth. While the extended summer has certainly provided a favourable consumption environment, the brand’s momentum has been driven by far more fundamental factors.”

She added that the brand’s focus on the ₹10 price point had been instrumental in accelerating its growth by making it more accessible.

Akshali Shah, ED, Parag Milk Foods, said the momentum for dairy-based beverages is being driven by a broader structural shift in consumer preferences towards beverages that offer a combination of taste, convenience and nutrition.

S. Korea, Taiwan stocks fall as investors reassess AI bets

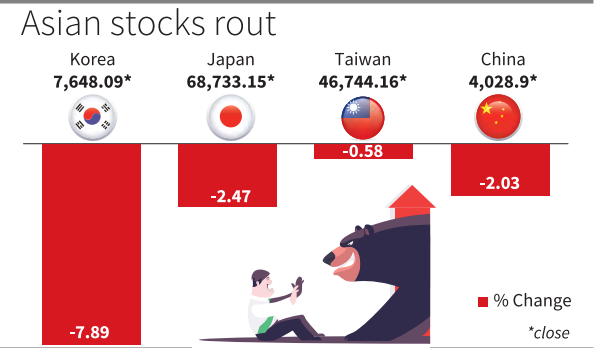
Reuters

AI-linked markets in South Korea and Taiwan fell on Thursday, with Seoul’s benchmark dropping 8 per cent, as concerns over potential overcapacity prompted investors to pare semiconductor holdings.

South Korea’s KOSPI, home to many companies tied to the AI infrastructure buildout, has been volatile this year. Thursday’s loss was the worst since June 23.

A blistering AI rally over the past year has also made the sector vulnerable to sudden swings in investor sentiment.

Chipmakers Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix shed 9.1 per cent and 14.6 per cent, respectively. US



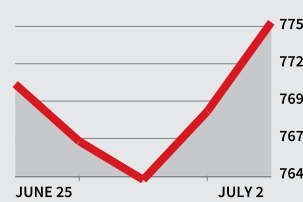
chipmakers dragged the benchmarks there after media reports said Meta Platforms plans to sell access to its AI computing power and models. It fuelled concerns that the company may have overbuilt capacity, setting the stage for the selloff in Asia. Sentiment soured further on media reports that

Apple was considering sourcing memory chips from two Chinese manufacturers, a move that could challenge South Korean chipmakers.

Taiwan stocks also dropped as much as 2 per cent, dragged lower by chipmaker TSMC, which fell 1.6 per cent. The index later ended 0.6 per cent lower.

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77502.12 (+579.48)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24175.70	+169.85
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.04	+0.16
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.39	+0.15
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	142430.00	+1365
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	228850.00	+3420



FACING HEADWINDS.

SpiceJet has cut flights in July by 44 per cent compared to April amid a tough operating environment **p12**

WEST ASIA WOES.

India's LPG consumption fell 8 per cent y-o-y to 14.74 mt in the first half of this year **p3**

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QUICKLY.

ODISHA ALUMINIUM UNIT
Adani, Abu Dhabi's IHC plan ₹1.08 lakh cr project



Bhubaneshwar: Adani Enterprises and Abu Dhabi-based natural resources investment platform IHC Group have signed an MoU with the Odisha government to invest ₹1.08 lakh crore to set up an integrated aluminium project. IHC Group will make the investment in the project through its subsidiary 2PointZero. The 50:50 JV company will set up a 4 mtpa alumina refinery at the foothill of Sasubahu Mali bauxite mine in Rayagada district. **p2**

SIMPLIFIED PROCESS

Eight lakh new GST registrations in 2026 H1

New Delhi: Nearly 8 lakh new GST registrations happened in January-June, the first half of 2026, data from the Goods and Services Tax portal showed. Experts listed various reasons, including ease of registration, which led to ease of compliance. **p11**

SC scraps tribunal rulings over fake AI precedents

TECH WOES. Says unregulated AI a threat, asks Bar Council to frame usage norms

Shishir Sinha

New Delhi

In a landmark ruling that could shape the use of artificial intelligence in India's legal system, the Supreme Court on Thursday set aside judgments of the National Company Law Tribunal and the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal after finding that they had relied on fake judicial precedents generated by AI.

CATASTROPHIC

Calling the use of hallucinated case law the legal equivalent of the methyl isocyanate leak in the Bhopal gas tragedy, the same "invisible, insidious and catastrophic by the time anyone notices", the court warned that unregulated AI poses a grave threat to the integrity of the justice delivery system.

The Bench also directed the Bar Council of India to frame norms in this regard. The case arose from insolvency proceedings involving Essel Infraprojects Ltd,

SC flags (mis)use of AI

Case cited by NCLT	What SC Found
State Bank of India vs Shree Ram Urban Infrastructure	Wrong citation of an existing reported judgment and a non-existent paragraph
Everest Kento Cylinders Ltd vs Union of India	Correct citation but non-existent paragraph
ICICI Bank Ltd vs Urban Infrastructure Real Estate	Non-existent citation
V S Dempo & Co Ltd vs Reliance Communications	Non-existent citation
Canara Bank vs N G Subbaraya Setty & Anr	Correct citation but non-existent paragraph

where the NCLT admitted a lender's plea under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code and the NCLAT upheld the decision. A Division Bench comprising Justices Pamidighantam Sri Narasimha and Alok Aradhe found that several precedents cited by the tribunals were either non-existent or contained fabricated passages wrongly attributed to genuine judgments, rendering both orders legally unsustainable.

"A decision of a court or an adjudicating authority based

on material that is fake and hallucinated is no decision at all, and it amounts to subversion of the rule of law. Such a decision is unsustainable and has to be set aside at the earliest," said the Bench.

The Bench clarified that it was not dealing with the cause of hallucinations or the technical process for resolving them, which it said was for engineers and scientists to deal with. For courts and lawyers, the concern was the production of fake and non-existing material and their use as precedents in

law. The Bench emphasised that technology cannot replace human adjudication.

It said: "AI... is not just an aid to assist us in our work, but is an alternative to our own thinking, reasoning and even decision making... Unregulated use of AI will insidiously enter legal practice, the process of judicial decision-making and decision-making itself."

ZERO-TOLERANCE

The Bench called for adopting a zero-tolerance mode for producing, citing or using AI-generated precedents without verification.

Accordingly, it directed the Bar Council of India to constitute a committee and deliberate on the issue of members of the bar submitting fake and hallucinated material as if they are precedents of law. "We... resolve to adopt AI in aid of adjudication, while at the same time asserting and declaring total and absolute control over adjudication, with a human in the loop at every stage," said the judges.

BoB in \$600 m out-of-court settlement with NMC Health

Our Bureau

Mumbai



END OF MATTER. The bank said the settlement is to bring the disputes to conclusion, thereby avoiding prolonged litigation

Health PLC, NMC Holding Ltd and NMC Healthcare Ltd.

CLAIMS SETTLED

Bank of Baroda agreed to pay to settle claims brought by the administrators of the collapsed NMC group.

The administrators alleged that certain financing and lending arrangements involving BoB helped facilitate or failed to detect activities that concealed NMC's true financial position.

Bank of Baroda denied the allegations, but chose to settle the litigation without admitting liability.

The bank observed that NMC Health PLC, NMC Healthcare Ltd, NMC Holding Ltd and their respective joint administrators had resolved the claims between them and BoB in considera-

tion for payment of \$600 million, pursuant to a settlement agreement.

"All claims, causes of action between them have been resolved without admission of liability or wrongdoing. The settlement agreement and its terms otherwise remain confidential. The liability of the bank in these proceedings is limited to this sum. Pursuant to the settlement agreement, the ADGM proceedings have been discontinued. The UK proceedings are in the process of being discontinued," said BoB.

"The settlement is to bring the disputes to conclusion, thereby avoiding prolonged litigation, uncertainty and associated cost," added BoB. The settlement ends claims against the bank, said sources.

In major reprieve for auto sector, Centre waives ₹2,700 crore CAFE-2 penalties

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

In a major development, the Centre has bailed out all major vehicle manufacturers, including Hyundai Motor India (HMIL), Kia India and Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M), from paying heavy penalties, collectively totalling ₹2,700 crore, for violating the Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE-2) norms.

PMO INTERVENES

Following a crucial Prime Minister's Office (PMO) intervention earlier this year that halted CAFE-3 implementation until past penalties were resolved, the Ministry of Power issued an official directive to the car-makers on Thursday.

"Notice is hereby given that the said draft amendments will be taken into consideration after the expiry of thirty days from the date of this notification as published in the Gazette of India, and are made available to the public... any objections or suggestions which may be received from any person in respect of the said draft amendments before the expiry of the aforesaid period will be considered by the Central government," said sources quoting the Ministry letter.

The letter is addressed to the Managing Directors and Chief Executive Officers of 18 automakers, including HMIL, Kia India, M&M, Maruti Suzuki India, Honda Cars India, Force Motors, JSW MG Motor, Renault India, Toyota Kirloskar Motor,

Nissan India, Skoda Auto Volkswagen India, Mercedes-Benz India and BMW Group India.

Under CAFE-2 norms, HMIL had the maximum number of penalties up to ₹3,000 crore, followed by M&M at ₹1,800 crore and Kia India at ₹1,350 crore.

The final order entirely wipes out the industry's liabilities, which the government had already drastically reduced to around ₹2,700 crore from an initial estimate of roughly ₹8,800 crore.

Further, the Centre has extended the compliance runway by allowing automakers to offset their emissions debits all the way through September 30, 2027, stretching beyond the previously suggested March 31, 2027, deadline via the exchange of carbon credits.

EMISSION TARGETS

The penalties were originally triggered because the automakers breached fleet-wide carbon-dioxide emission targets, which require a manufacturer's total annual sales volume to meet strict average fuel-efficiency standards.

Under the original rules, heavy-emission vehicles like SUVs had to be structurally balanced out by electric vehicles or fuel-efficient models within the same financial year, or face compounding fines per vehicle sold.

However, sources close to the development told *businessline* that the new framework fundamentally dilutes these rules; automakers no longer face immediate penalties for missing end-of-year targets.

SHARED VISION



STRATEGIC TIES. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi take a car ride during the latter's visit to New Delhi on Thursday. India and Japan agreed to deepen co-operation in strengthening economic and energy security, artificial intelligence, resilient supply chains, and defence, among others (**Reports on Page 3**) **p11**

Why tech start-ups are dashing to list

Time to IPO from first fund-raise down to 8 years on robust values, investors seeking exit

Rohan Das

Chennai

It's just an eight-year dash to the bourses now for many Indian tech start-ups, which are speeding to the public market in record time. According to new data from market research firm Tracxn, the 13 tech start-ups that went public in the first half of calendar 2026 took an average of just eight years from their first funding round to listing.

This is a big acceleration compared to the first half of 2025 when the journey to IPO for start-ups was 14-and-half-years.

Experts suggest that the reason for the fast pace is due to the attractive public market valuations in India that are pushing private equity investors towards faster exits. At the same



SIGN OF THE TIMES. Many start-ups, especially in new-age sectors, have impressive valuations in the public market

time, the improved corporate governance practices in many new-age companies are making them much healthier candidates for the bourses.

Sumeet Abrol, Partner and Deals Lifecycle Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat, says that in recent years, many start-ups, especially in new-age sectors, have commanded impressive valuations in public markets. "Sometimes, even better than securing another private round," he said.

This has naturally made market debut an attractive option.

VELOCITY OF CAPITAL

Abrol believes that the push is coming as much from the investors as the founders. He says that many PE firms that deployed capital during the boom years are now looking for exits and nudging the start-ups toward IPOs. "The domestic liquidity has improved a lot as well, so companies don't have to depend as much on

foreign institutional investors to support large IPOs," he added.

Anil Joshi, Founder and Managing Partner at Unicorn India Ventures and VC Council member, IVCA, suggests that policy reforms and SEBI's efforts to streamline the listing process have made the public markets more efficient.

"Investors have become increasingly comfortable valuing and investing in new-age, technology-led businesses," he said. Moreover, the companies that plan to float IPOs start preparing compliance readiness in advance, he added.

Abrol adds that firms today begin building independent boards, improve financial reporting standards and comply with other requirements much before listings are contemplated.

Cut in petrol, diesel prices possible only if oil rates stay low for a few weeks, says Minister

Rishi Ranjan Kala

New Delhi

Emphasising that the price hikes in petrol and diesel were among the lowest in India during the West Asia conflict, Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri said on Thursday that a cut in the retail prices of the two auto fuels would be possible only if international crude oil prices stay at the same level for the next few weeks.

RETAIL PRICES

Asked if the government will reduce retail prices of petrol and diesel, Puri said: "This would be a legitimate question if oil prices stay low for next few weeks."

On Thursday evening, Brent was at \$70.91 per barrel, WTI at \$67.83 and Murban at \$64.33 a barrel.

The Minister highlighted that the government shielded the consumer from the



Instead of passing the increased costs on to consumers, the government absorbed the burden through the budget and fiscal system

HARDEEP SINGH PURI

Oil Minister



full impact of the volatility in prices of crude oil, LNG and LPG during the conflict in West Asia, which is now considered as the largest disruption in energy in history.

"Instead of passing the increased costs on to consumers, the government absorbed the burden through the budget and fiscal system," he said.

Even as global crude prices have eased in recent weeks, the impact of the

earlier surge is still being felt because refiners are processing crude purchased when prices were significantly higher, he added.

India procures crude at least 45 days in advance. For instance, for July delivery, the crude oil would have been booked in May.

OMC LOSSES

Detailing the losses suffered by the PSU oil marketing companies, Puri said the

OMCs took a hit of around ₹74,781 crore till June.

Similarly, the under recoveries of the PSU OMCs swelled to a whopping ₹2.18 lakh crore at the end of June due to sale of petrol, diesel and LPG to consumers at below-market rates to shield them from price volatility, he added.

On addressing similar situations and tackling price volatility, Puri explained: "My answer to that self-inflicted question is that I'm not worried about it, but I have to prepare for it. Stocking up [crude] as prices are low, increasing my storage space to intensifying our outreach to our bilateral partners, all that will go hand in hand."

On increasing storage capacity, including strategic storage, he said: "Maybe that's one of the lessons we've learnt. We have learned the lesson and we will try to increase storage."

QUICKLY.

Adar Poonawalla Family Office invests in RE firm

Ahmedabad: Adar Poonawalla Family Office, through Rising Sun Holdings, has invested ₹700 crore in Inox Clean Energy, the integrated renewable energy platform of the INOXGFL Group, as the company gears up for its next phase of expansion across renewable power generation and solar manufacturing. Rising Sun Holdings will acquire a 1 per cent stake in Inox Clean, according to sources. **OUR BUREAU**

Ninjacart raises \$6 million from existing investors

Bengaluru: Agritech firm Ninjacart said it has closed \$6 million funding in a multi-tranche investment round led by existing investors Accel, Nandan Nilekani and Tiger Global, while more existing investors are expected to join the round soon. It has turned EBITDA-profitable and has begun preparations for a public listing over the next two years, a company statement said. **OUR BUREAU**

Adani Enterprises, IHC Group to invest ₹1.08 lakh cr in Odisha aluminium JV

MEGA PROJECT. Massive investment to create alumina refinery, smelter, power plant and 53,500 jobs

Suresh P Iyengar
Bhubaneswar

Adani Enterprises and Abu Dhabi-based natural resources investment platform IHC Group have signed a memorandum of understanding with the Odisha government to invest ₹1.08 lakh crore to set up an integrated aluminium project from mining to value-added products. The IHC Group will make the investment in the project through its subsidiary 2PointZero.

As part of the largest foreign direct investment in the metallurgy sector, the 50:50 joint venture (JV) company will set up a 4 million tonnes per annum (mtpa) alumina refinery at the foothill of the Sasubahu Mali bauxite mine in Rayagada district, besides a 2-mtpa aluminium smelter, a 4,000-megawatt (MW) captive power plant, including 400 MW of green energy, and a 1-mtpa downstream



If done at a very competitive rate, India can be a net exporter of aluminium; we are not looking to compete with anybody, as there is enough room for everyone

KARAN ADANI
Director, Adani Enterprises



manufacturing park at Sundargarh district, which is close to a coal mine.

The project is expected to generate about 53,500 jobs across construction and operations.

Karan Adani, Director, Adani Enterprises, said, “The project will take 12 months to get all the approvals and another three-four years to set up the first phase of the project, which will include

the alumina refinery, power plant and aluminium plant.”

He added that the company’s portion of investment of ₹54,000 crore in the project will be funded through a mix of internal accruals, 70 per cent debt and 30 per cent equity.

FULL VALUE CHAIN
Mohan Charan Majhi, Chief Minister of Odisha, said the State will make an entry into

the global aluminium supply chain and value-added product manufacturing with the new project. The investment will enable Odisha to develop the complete aluminium value chain, from mining and refining to smelting and downstream manufacturing, creating greater value within the State, he added.

Asked what will be the role of Odisha Mining Corporation, Adani said the State government company has a lot of bauxite mines and the new JV company will be working with the government to get a long-term bauxite linkage besides bidding in the mine auction.

On the necessity to enter the aluminium sector, he said the entire process of aluminium production is energy intensive and being a low-cost energy producer, it made sense for the Adani Group to enter this sector. Odisha also has all the elements to make aluminium

production most cost competitive, he said.

Moreover, with all the emphasis on digitisation and manufacturing in the country, the demand for aluminium will go up and the group sees long-term opportunity in this space, he added.

Asked whether the company will be competing with established players like Hindalco Industries and Vedanta Aluminium, Adani said even with such large capacities, India still imports large quantities of aluminium, which is a sign of additional demand and there is going to be enough room for everyone in this market. “If done at a very competitive rate, India can be a net exporter of aluminium as well. We are not looking to compete with anybody, as there is enough room for everyone,” he added.

The reporter was in Odisha on the Adani Group’s invitation

Navratna status gives CPCL more autonomy for faster expansion: MD

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



H Shankar, CPCL Managing Director

Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd (CPCL) plans to leverage its newly-acquired Navratna status to accelerate capacity expansion, diversify into high-value petroleum products and pursue joint ventures (JVs). The enhanced autonomy will allow its board to take major investment decisions without seeking further approval from parent Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL), CPCL MD H Shankar told *businessline*.

The Navratna status marks a significant milestone for the company, making CPCL the first single-location public sector enterprise from Tamil Nadu to receive the recognition, Shankar said.

Neyveli Lignite Corporation, also a Navratna company, has operations in Tamil Nadu and in other States.

FASTER DECISIONS

“The biggest advantage of being a Navratna is the autonomy it gives the company. It enables faster decision-making and places greater responsibility on the CPCL board to evaluate and approve projects,” Shankar said.

Earlier, CPCL had to obtain approval from IOCL’s board for capital expenditure projects exceeding ₹500 crore. Following the grant of Navratna status, there is no upper limit on capital expenditure for independently-funded projects approved by the company’s board.

“There is no cap on investment for independent projects. The board will take decisions after evaluating the company’s financial strength, internal rate of return, project viability and gestation period,” Shankar said.

Shankar said the company will initiate discussions with

potential downstream industries — to explore partnerships for producing value-added products.

“We have the feedstock, financial strength and now greater operational flexibility. We are evaluating opportunities where these strengths can be combined with the technical expertise of downstream companies,” he said.

The enhanced powers also provide greater flexibility to form JVs. Under the Navratna guidelines, CPCL can approve equity investments of up to 15 per cent of its net worth in a single JV or wholly-owned subsidiary, subject to a ceiling of ₹1,000 crore. The overall investment in such ventures is capped at 30 per cent of the company’s net worth, he said.

NEXT GROWTH PHASE

CPCL is simultaneously preparing its next phase of growth. It has appointed Engineers India to undertake a feasibility study for expanding the capacity of its Manali refinery, with the report expected to be submitted over the next two-three months.

On the retail front, CPCL has already secured board approval to invest around ₹400 crore to establish 300 fuel retail outlets across India under its Sooper brand.

Shankar said the company would review the performance of the first phase before seeking approval for further expansion.

‘Operating environment more challenging now in the Netherlands’

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Tata Steel’s 7 million tonnes per annum (mtpa) Netherlands steel plant seems to be facing fresh regulatory pressure in its decarbonisation journey.

Chairman N Chandrasekaran said the “operating environment” in the country has become more “challenging” after environmental norms were tightened to levels significantly above European Union (EU) standards.

The development comes at a critical juncture for Tata Steel Nederland, which has staged a sharp operational

recovery with EBITDA more than tripling to €267 million in FY26.

“The operating environment has become more challenging. The recent environmental regulations in the Netherlands far exceed the EU standards. Some of the legacy assets of Tata Steel Nederland will find it hard to meet the norms in the accepted timelines,” Chandrasekaran said at the company’s annual general meeting.

Despite the regulatory overhang, Tata Steel Nederland has delivered a sharp operational recovery after years of restructuring, with EBITDA rising to €267 million in FY26 from significant



N Chandrasekaran, Chairman, Tata Steel

antly lower levels in the previous year.

FURTHER IMPROVE
According to Chandrasekaran, EBITDA for FY27 has been projected at €400-500 million, support-

ted by structural interventions undertaken over the past few years.

The long-term outlook remains strong, with the company targeting EBITDA of €800 million to €1 billion over time, subject to resolution of regulatory challenges.

He said the company has initiated discussions with the Dutch government and regulators for a viable path forward.

PUBLIC FUNDING
According to the company’s FY26 annual report, the decarbonisation plan for Tata Steel Nederland is backed by a joint letter of intent with the Dutch government and envisages conditional public

funding of up to €2 billion. The transition roadmap includes the phased closure of one blast furnace and one coke and gas plant, along with investments aimed at improving environmental performance and long-term sustainability of operations at the IJmuiden plant.

To further strengthen the asset base, Tata Steel has also acquired Vattenfall’s cogeneration power plants in the Netherlands. “Since the acquisition, we have not funded Nederland. All their operations are being funded by the cash they generate. They have paid dividends over these years,” he said.

While the Netherlands remains the most complex

overseas market for Tata Steel from a regulatory standpoint, the company continues to pursue a broader European restructuring strategy, including a major transition in the UK. “In the UK, the EBITDA losses were reduced by half than the previous year,” Chandrasekaran said.

He said the transition marks a decisive shift away from legacy steelmaking in the UK towards a more sustainable and lower-emission production model. “For the Canada operations, a lot of work has been done to bring in efficiencies. But still it is loss making and we are trying to find a solution,” he said.

Hero, Ather and Greaves drive 58 per cent of India’s incremental e2W sales in H1 CY26

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



An analysis of Vahan retail registration data by *businessline* shows that Hero MotoCorp, Ather Energy, Greaves Electric Mobility, River and BGauss contributed 1,90,054 of the industry’s 3,25,286 additional electric two-wheelers (e2Ws) sold during H1 CY26, accounting for 58.4 per cent of incremental sales.

Their combined market share expanded to 37 per cent in H1 CY26 from 26 per cent a year earlier, indicating the market is evolving into a broader, more competitive ecosystem.

STRUCTURAL SHIFT

The biggest structural shift is occurring below the market leaders. Greaves Electric Mobility, River and BGauss are transforming what was once a fragmented tail of smaller manufacturers into a meaningful middle tier, reducing the industry’s reliance on a few big brands.

Greaves delivered one of the strongest performances. H1 registrations rose 65.2 per cent, ahead of the industry’s 51.4 per cent growth, while Q1 registrations jumped 94.4 per cent versus the industry’s 63.9 per cent. June registrations increased 31.1 per cent over May—the strongest month-on-month gain among leading OEMs—as the company crossed 10,000 monthly registrations.

“Crossing the four-lakh milestone reflects the growing trust customers have placed in Ampere, as electric mobility moves into the mainstream,” said Vikas

Singh, MD, Greaves Electric Mobility, adding that wider retail reach, durable products and lower ownership costs would drive long-term growth.

River continued scaling rapidly from a small base, while BGauss maintained strong momentum. BGauss’ H1 registrations grew 82.1 per cent, with Q1 volumes more than doubling and June registrations rising 12 per cent over May. “As customers become more confident about electric mobility, they are evaluating products on quality, reliability, safety and after-sales support,” said Hemant Kabra, Founder and MD, BGauss Electric.

Hero MotoCorp emerged as the industry’s biggest breakout story. H1 registrations more than tripled to 104,417 units from 34,379 a year earlier, while Q1 FY27 registrations surged 155.8 per cent, signalling that its EV strategy is gaining scale. Ather Energy also strengthened its position as

the leading pure-play e2W manufacturer. H1 registrations nearly doubled to 167,176 units.

KEY DRIVERS

Analysts attribute the market expansion to both improving economics and stronger product offerings. Higher fuel prices following geopolitical tensions in West Asia widened the running-cost advantage of e2Ws. “Two-wheelers remain India’s most price-sensitive vehicle category, but the EV shift is supported by running-cost economics,” said Ankit Patel, Co-Founder and Partner, Arunasset Investment Services.

E2W penetration rose to 8.5 per cent in H1 CY26 from 6.6 per cent in H1 CY25, while June reached 10.5 per cent, according to Equirius Securities. The data also suggest incremental demand is increasingly being shared by a wider group of manufacturers, creating a more balanced and competitive market.

Bajaj’s EV push gains pace as conventional two-wheeler sales lag industry growth in June

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



India’s petrol-powered two-wheeler registrations grew 16.7 per cent year-on-year in June, slower than the overall two-wheeler market’s 21 per cent expansion but still reflecting healthy demand for conventional motorcycles and scooters.

However, it still reflecting healthy demand for conventional motorcycles and scooters.

Hero MotoCorp’s petrol-powered portfolio grew 14.1 per cent to 4,46,844 units. Honda Motorcycle & Scooter India’s (HMSI’s) sales rose 20.6 per cent to 4,47,328 units, while TVS Motor’s increased 17.3 per cent to 3,09,693 units.

Bajaj Auto, however, emerged as the outlier. Its petrol-powered portfolio grew just 2.1 per cent to 1,43,520 units even as overall retail sales increased 13.5 per cent, highlighting the

growing contribution of electric vehicles (EVs).

GRADUAL SHIFT

According to an analysis of Vahan retail registrations by *businessline*, India’s two-wheeler market added 3,13,830 retail sales in June to reach 1.81 million units.

Petrol-powered models accounted for 1.62 million sales, underlining that internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles remain the backbone of the market despite the industry’s gradual shift towards electrification.

Bajaj best illustrates that transition. The company re-tailed 1,86,696 two-wheelers, of which 43,176 were electric, taking EV penetration to 23.1 per cent—the highest among India’s major legacy manufacturers.

Nearly one in every four Bajaj two-wheelers sold in June was electric, helping offset its sluggish ICE growth.

TVS Motor was the most balanced legacy player. Over-

all retail sales rose 22.6 per cent to 3,56,240 units, while petrol-powered registrations increased 17.3 per cent to 3,09,693 units. EVs contributed 46,547 units, taking EV penetration to 13.1 per cent.

Hero MotoCorp continues to derive most of its growth from conventional motorcycles and scooters. Total retail sales rose 17.3 per cent to 4,68,639 units, while EVs accounted for just 4.7 per cent of sales.

HMSI remains overwhelmingly ICE-led. It re-tailed 4,48,130 two-wheelers, with EVs contributing only 802 units, or 0.18 per cent of total sales. Suzuki,

Yamaha and Royal Enfield also remain almost entirely dependent on petrol-powered models, with EV penetration below 1 per cent.

TRANSITION PATH

Hemal Thakkar, Senior Practice Leader and Senior Director at Crisil Intelligence, said the numbers show manufacturers moving through different stages of electrification rather than following a common transition path.

“The ICE business continues to remain the volume and profitability engine for most two-wheeler manufacturers, so companies cannot afford to neglect it. At the same time, OEMs that have invested early in electric mobility are beginning to create an additional growth lever. Over the next few years, investors will increasingly look at how successfully manufacturers balance both businesses rather than evaluating either in isolation,” he said.

Our goal is to bring innovation faster to India: AstraZeneca India Managing Director

bl.interview

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

“Faster” seems to be the operative word for Praveen Rao Akkinapally, Managing Director, AstraZeneca Pharma India, as the biopharmaceutical drugmaker looks to bring global innovations into India, closer to their international launches. The pathway to this is through greater clinical trial participation from India, Akkinapally told *businessline*, as he completes a year at the top job.

Edited excerpts:

How has a year at the helm been for you?
I’ve been with AstraZeneca

for most of my career, well over 20 years. What we focused on globally is to push the boundaries of science to deliver life-changing medicines.

We’ve been able to bring that global innovation to India. We’ve had, in the financial year, over 11 approvals...in areas where there is a huge unmet need in India. The most important highlight over the last year is that we have been able to bring innovation faster to India.

India has increasingly become a very important strategic market for us globally — from a commercial perspective and our operations. We now have almost 5,000 people in India across different areas — one of the largest footprints across the world. For me, though I’ve

spent the last 20-30 years in the US, it’s been incredibly meaningful to contribute to that story.

Have the recent global supply constraints affected AstraZeneca?

This has been difficult across the world, but AstraZeneca has a pretty broad and resilient supply chain. We always plan for contingencies. To answer your question: No, it has not had any material impact in terms of the availability of our life-saving medicines in India.

You have surrendered your manufacturing licence here. Are you having re-thoughts? Is it a good idea to largely import or contract manufacture?

We’ve got a global supply



We now have almost 5,000 people in India across different areas — one of the largest footprints across the world

PRAVEEN RAO AKKINAPALLY
MD, AstraZeneca Pharma India



chain system, one that we review every year as part of our strategic focus, like most other multinational companies. The products that were manufactured here were some of the older legacy products rather than the newer portfolio. They weren’t material contributors to the growth of AstraZeneca in India.

It has not really had much

that is manufactured by AstraZeneca itself at our global sites.

What are your plans for your key segments?

AstraZeneca is focused broadly on oncology (increasingly our largest segment globally and in India); biopharmaceuticals (cardiovascular, renal, respiratory, immunology and vaccines); and rare diseases. What we plan is threefold — first, ensure we have a strong presence in terms of Indian representation in our clinical trials.

In fact, the vast majority of our Phase-III clinical trials now have a significant proportion of patients coming from India. I would say it’s probably one of the leading MNC representations of clinical trials in the country.

Increasingly, we will ensure that we’ve got robust evidence from India contributing to our global trials, which in turn will help us with our second goal: To bring our innovation faster to India.

Last year, we had examples where we launched an indication in India within 70 days of US approval. It was unheard of. One of the reasons we’ve been able to do that is because we’ve really prioritised our presence in India, and we are translating that into our engagement and clinical strategy in the country.

Across oncology, biopharmaceuticals and rare diseases, we are planning on bringing our global innovative portfolio to India and doing it as fast as we can so that patients in India have access to these innovations and do

not have to wait for years.

Could you share details on the clinical trials that India is participating in?

Majority of our trials in India are in the oncology and biopharmaceuticals space, which is where we have most of our presence. That number is very dynamic... It is now close to 80 and counting, because we are increasingly bringing our trials here.

businessline.

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QUICKLY.
BPCL buys Videocon's
Brazil oil and gas stake



New Delhi: State-owned Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd (BPCL) has acquired Videocon's remaining stake in Brazilian joint venture IBV Brasil Petróleo Ltda, taking full ownership of the company as it seeks to expand its overseas upstream portfolio and strengthen long-term energy supplies. The acquisition, completed through BPCL's upstream arm Bharat PetroResources Ltd (BPRL) and its step-down subsidiaries, increases BPRL's stake in IBV to 100 per cent from 65.4 per cent, making the Brazilian company its wholly-owned subsidiary, the company said in a statement. **PTI**

‘Green hydrogen mission wooing global investments’

New Delhi: The National Green Hydrogen Mission is attracting global investments, building international partnerships, and opening new markets for Indian green hydrogen and its derivatives, Union Minister Pralhad Joshi said. The initiative under Prime Minister Narendra Modi is creating a strong and future-ready ecosystem, the Minister for New and Renewable Energy said. As per the statement, ACME Cleantech Solutions has secured a long-term offtake deal with leading Japanese companies — IHI Corp for green ammonia and Mitsubishi Gas Chemical Company, Inc for green methanol. **PTI**

Modi, Takaichi initiate ties in AI, economic security, energy

TRADE BOOST. About 120 co-operation documents between Indian and Japanese firms announced

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi on Thursday agreed to deepen co-operation in strengthening economic and energy security, artificial intelligence, resilient supply chains and defence, unveiling a series of initiatives and agreements while reaffirming the goal of attracting 10 trillion yen in Japanese investment into India over the next decade.

“In today's era of uncertainty, both India and Japan fully understand the importance of economic and energy security. To this end, we have today prepared a joint roadmap for economic security. Through this, we will strengthen supply chain resilience in strategic sectors such as semiconductors, quantum technology and advanced materials. We have also taken several significant decisions regarding energy security,” Modi said after summit talks with Takaichi.

The meeting assumed added significance in the backdrop of growing geopolitical uncertainty and heightened strategic competition in the Indo-Pacific amid China's expanding influence in the region.

STRATEGIC TIE-UP
Highlighting the role of businesses in strengthening bilateral ties, Takaichi said



DEEPENING CO-OPERATION. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with his Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi in New Delhi on Thursday **SHIV KUMAR PUSHKAR**

around 120 cooperation documents between Indian and Japanese companies, involving 2 trillion yen in investments, were announced during the visit.

“It is a desire to forge a path towards future in India and Japan through unified efforts of public and private sectors,” she said.

Referring to Takaichi as his “younger sister”, Modi said the two countries would deepen collaboration in emerging technologies while working to double the number of Japanese companies operating in India.

Takaichi described Modi as her “bigger brother” and said India-Japan ties were

entering a new phase.

“Prime Minister Takaichi and I believe that the technology partnership will become the strongest pillar of our co-operation. To realise this vision, we have issued a joint statement on AI today,” Modi said, adding that the convergence of Japan's precision technologies and India's software capabilities would give fresh momentum to global AI development. Several Indian institutions also signed agreements with Japanese partners to strengthen AI collaboration.

BUSINESS PACTS
Modi said more than 100 business agreements con-

cluded over the past year are expected to bring over \$10 billion in Japanese investment into India. “Today's agreement between the Financial Services Agencies will further facilitate the flow of capital and investment. Our goal is clear — 10 trillion yen of Japanese investment in India over the next 10 years and doubling the number of Japanese companies in the country,” he said.

The two countries signed their first defence co-development project involving the Unicorn naval radio antenna, which Modi said would open “a new chapter” in bilateral defence technology cooperation.

On energy, India and Japan agreed to strengthen co-operation on energy resilience, including measures to tackle oil shocks, while expanding collaboration in batteries, green hydrogen and nuclear energy. They also launched the Japan-India Cooperative Biogas for Growth Initiative, under which Japan will support the setting up of 1,000 biogas and organic fertiliser plants in India.

The leaders also launched the ‘India-Japan Next-Generation Mobility Partnership Framework’ to expand co-operation beyond automobiles into shipbuilding, aviation and logistics.

Framework announced to deepen AI across research, infrastructure and governance

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India and Japan have announced an ambitious framework to deepen co-operation in artificial intelligence, agreeing to jointly develop large language models, strengthen AI infrastructure and supply chains, promote multilingual and open-source AI, and expand collaboration between governments, industry and academia.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi welcomed the signing of several significant memorandums to foster deeper collaboration in AI, an India-Japan joint statement on cooperation in the field of AI noted on Thursday. These include an MoU between the Indian Institute of Technology Bombay, BharatGen Technology Foundation and Japan's National Institute of Informatics for joint research and development of large language



TECH BOOST. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japan's PM Sanae Takaichi witness the exchange of an MoU between Ambassador of Japan to India Ono Keiichi and Ambassador of India to Japan Nagma Mohamed Mallick in New Delhi **SHIV KUMAR PUSHKAR**

models; an agreement between Sarvam and Preferred Networks to cooperate across the full AI technology stack; and a memorandum between IndiaAI Mission and Japan's Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry to support AI development companies in both countries.

AI MODELS
The two leaders also agreed to enhance cooperation on multilingual, open-source, domain-specific and vertical AI models, including models for native languages and

public-interest applications.

The two countries agreed to strengthen cooperation to enhance their competitiveness in AI and promote innovation-driven growth. They also decided to build resilient economic ecosystems aligned with India's MAHAS-AGAR vision and Japan's Free and Open Indo-Pacific strategy.

India and Japan agreed to elevate themselves as strategic research and development partners in AI. Cooperation will cover secure AI infrastructure, including data centres, GPUs, semi-

conductors and other compute resources, besides assessing opportunities and vulnerabilities across the AI technology stack from an economic security perspective.

On AI governance, the two sides highlighted the need for responsible innovation. “The two leaders reaffirmed the importance of promoting an international governance framework that is centred on safe, secure, trustworthy, robust, and inclusive AI that supports responsible innovation, while respecting national laws, priorities, and contexts,” the statement said.

The two governments also agreed to deepen industry-academia collaboration, expand joint research projects and researcher exchanges, and encourage Japanese companies to step up AI research and development partnerships in India. They reaffirmed the goal of bringing 500 highly skilled AI professionals from India to Japan by 2030.

To collaborate for fuel storage, maritime transport

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India and Japan on Thursday pledged to work together as major energy-consuming countries in Asia to jointly strengthen energy resilience in the light of the current geopolitical situation by deepening co-operation in strategic fuel reserves and maritime energy transport.

“Both sides highlighted the importance of regional initiatives to strengthen energy resilience, such as Japan's Partnership on Wide Energy and Resources Resilience (POWER Asia) and India's support for energy security in South Asia,” India's Oil Ministry said.

According to the joint statement, the two countries reaffirmed the importance of sharing their respective knowledge and experience, and, where appropriate, promoting concrete co-operation related to stockpiling systems and reserve mechanisms for crude oil and petroleum products.

Co-operation will focus on mechanisms related to national stockpiling systems and reserves,

including industry stockpiles, coordination regarding arrangements with producing countries and emergency response and market stabilisation. The two sides reaffirmed the importance of co-operation to address shared challenges of energy availability and affordability, through supply assurance, enhancing resilience and creating mechanisms to mitigate volatility, thereby strengthening the voice of oil and gas-consuming countries.

Here, the focus will be on cooperation on information-sharing on market trends and joint efforts for market stabilisation. They will also co-operate on exploring engagements for energy supplies from third countries and exploring commercial engagements for investments in the upstream sector in third countries. Another development is that India and Japan reaffirmed the importance of efficient maritime transport of oil and gas. Also, the two sides concurred in exploring collaborative opportunities, including joint investments, across the maritime energy transport value chain.

Defence pact: Stealth ‘Unicorn’ antenna mast to boost Navy capabilities

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

Twenty months after signing a memorandum of implementation (MoI) in Tokyo, India and Japan on Thursday formalised an agreement for co-development of the Naval Radio Antenna ‘Unicorn.’ It consolidates a wide array of separate communication, radar and surveillance antennas into a single mast which would be fitted on Indian Navy warships, enhancing their stealth, detection and secured communication capabilities.

Addressing the media along with his Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said the two nations will begin work towards joint development of defence technologies that help boost regional peace and maritime security.

“In the defence sector, we have signed an agreement today on the first co-development project between India and Japan. This project — involving the Naval Radio Antenna ‘Unicorn’ — will open a new chapter in our defence technology partnership. We will now jointly develop defence technologies that strengthen regional peace, maritime security, and the rules-based order,” Modi said.

State-owned Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) will collaborate with Japanese tech defence majors including NEC Corporation, Yokohama Rubber and Sampa Kogyo KK, to produce this in India.

As per the MoI inked on November 15, 2024, Japan will provide advanced design expertise of Nora-50 antenna, while India will focus on integration and co-production.

STEALTH TECH

India has become the second Asian country after the Philippines to have this Japanese stealth technology which is already mounted on Mogami-class frigates of the Japan Maritime Self-Defence

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LPG consumption falls 8% in first half of 2026 as West Asia conflict hits supply

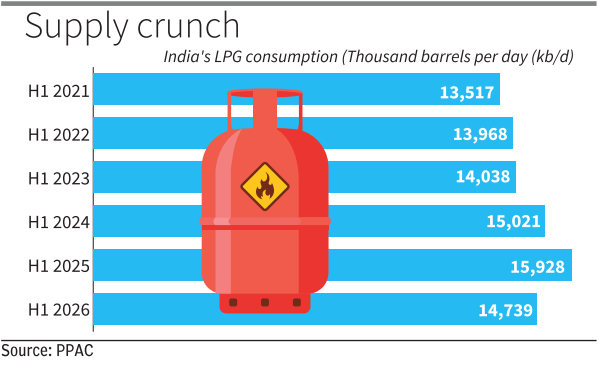
Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) consumption declined by 8 per cent y-o-y to around 14.74 million tonnes (mt) during the first half of the current calendar year as the West Asia conflict and the resultant closure of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) completely blocked off supply of the key cooking fuel.

According to the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC), India's LPG usage from January through June stood at 14.74 mt on a provisional basis, compared to 15.95 mt a year ago.

USAGE DOWN

The decline in consumption is entirely due to lower availability of LPG. India imports 60 per cent of its domestic requirement, of which 90 per cent comes from the Middle East Gulf (MEG) region, with most of the cargoes



transiting the Strait of Hormuz (SoH). During June, LPG usage declined by almost 17 per cent y-o-y to 2.18 mt on a provisional basis. However, consumption on a monthly basis rose by a little over 2 per cent as more LPG cargoes made it to Indian ports, particularly from the US, which emerged as India's largest supplier during March to June 2026.

May was the month when the impact of supply disruption clearly showed on India's consumption of the key

commodity, which is also the main cooking medium for more than 33.50 crore households, including over 10.50 crore beneficiaries who receive subsidised LPG under PM Ujjwala Yojna.

LPG consumption during May stood at roughly 2.13 mt, which is the lowest in the last 62 months, or more than 5 years. The lowest before this was during the Covid-impacted April 2021 (2.1 mt). Before 2021, the lowest consumption was recorded in April 2020 (2.11 mt), June

2019 (1.79 mt) and April 2019 (1.9 mt).

LPG consumption generally declines during the summers. As of early June 2026, India was consuming around 72,000 tonnes per day (TPD) of LPG. A back of the envelope calculation shows that the country's average usage stood at roughly 90,991 TPD in FY26, 85,830 TPD in FY25 and 81,271 TPD in FY24.

However, analysts, traders and refiners indicate that supplies will now get back on track with the signing of a memorandum of understanding between the US and Iran and the 60-day sanctions reprieve for Tehran, which is also reflecting in a higher number of vessels loaded with crude oil, LNG and LPG transiting the Strait of Hormuz. The government on Wednesday reduced the prices of commercial LPG and 5 kg LPG cylinders, an indication that the conflict in MEG, which intensified on February 28 is on the wane.

APPOINTMENT

National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development

NATIONAL BANK FOR FINANCING INFRASTRUCTURE AND DEVELOPMENT
Human Resources Department, Mumbai
www.nabfid.org

RECRUITMENT OF CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER (CEO), CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICER (CIO) & COMPLIANCE OFFICER (CO) FOR FUND MANAGEMENT ENTITY

National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development, set up under an Act of Parliament, 2021, is the principal entity for infrastructure financing in the country. The entity is regulated and supervised as an All-India Financial Institution (AIFI) by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Institution is poised to play an extremely crucial role in supporting infrastructure funding by driving the development of innovative financing instruments and development of bond and derivatives markets and promoting best practices in financing and data-driven risk management.

Institution is setting up a Fund Management Entity as a step-down subsidiary of NaBFID and is hiring for the following positions in this new entity.

Online Applications are invited from Indian Citizens for appointment on fixed term (contract basis) as per details given below:

SNo	Post/Grade	Vacancy	Advertisement No.
1	Chief Executive Officer	01	NaBFID/REC/FME/2026-27/01
2	Chief Investment Officer	01	
3	Compliance Officer	01	

1. For eligibility criteria (age, experience, job profile etc.), vacancy and other details, please visit the Bank's website <https://nabfid.org/careers> or scan the QR code.

2. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying. **Application starts from 03/07/2026.**

3. Remuneration will be offered based on qualification, experience, suitability, last drawn salary, market benchmark, as per advertisement. For other information, please refer detailed advertisement on the Banks website.

4. Location of position(s) will be based out of GIFT City (Gujarat International Finance Tech-City), Gujarat.

5. Any addendum / corrigendum / modification in this regard will ONLY be available on the Bank's website.

6. Selection will be solely at the discretion of the Bank, and its decision will be final.

Mumbai
Executive Vice President (HR)

Stand firm

India should not rush into trade deal with the US

The departure last month of United States Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer from New Delhi without the promised delivery of an interim trade agreement effectively means that a complete reassessment of the India-US Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) is under way. New Delhi has reportedly dug its heels on safeguards against future unilateral US tariff actions and securing better market access than competitors such as Bangladesh and Vietnam.



The caution from the Indian side is warranted. Even a cursory assessment of the February 6 joint statement, a precursor to the deal, makes it clear that the framework privileges US trade interests and export access over two-way benefits. India was expected to reduce or eliminate tariffs on most products. The US merely offered to reduce its Liberation Day ‘reciprocal’ or retaliatory tariffs — which were anyway illegal under the WTO framework for being country-specific — from 25 per cent (50 per cent, initially) to 18 per cent. Even that concession seems irrelevant in the wake of the US Supreme Court’s February 20 ruling which invalidates reciprocal tariffs. The very premise underlying the sole concession offered by the US has ceased to hold. Compare this with the commitments expected from New Delhi. India committed to purchase \$500 billion worth of goods and services over a period from a mercantilist US, which made no such reciprocal commitment. India is also expected to address long-standing non-tariff barriers (read GM) affecting US farm produce, and alter standards and norms for imports of US medical devices and Information and Communication Technology (ICT) goods, without corresponding commitments from Washington. Clearly, the joint statement is a one-way street, aimed at reducing US’ \$58 billion (2025) goods trade deficit with India, even as services trade is in balance. US has an overwhelming presence in India’s digital markets.

In the face of an adverse Supreme Court ruling, the US has resorted to other means to keep the tariff pot boiling. It has imposed temporary 10 per cent tariffs under Section 122 of the Trade Act, 1974 on imports from all trading partners. This blanket imposition, even on countries that had agreed to major concessions under new trade deals, reveals that the US is not above reneging on agreements. The Section 122 tariffs, in force only for 150 days, are scheduled to expire on July 24. To continue leveraging tariffs in talks, including with India, the US has now launched two investigations under Section 301. For India to undertake long-term commitments to escape possible future Section 301 tariffs is an unacceptable proposition. It will remain vulnerable to unilateral actions, anyway.

The better option is to continue engaging with the US without yielding to pressures. After all, FY26 exports to the US remained resilient, up by 1 per cent to \$87.3 billion — despite the tariff tantrums. A hastily signed trade agreement under the present framework may jeopardise long-term interests.

POCKET RAVIKANTH



Rupee’s pain has a global address

THE DOLLAR TRAP. Much of India’s global trade is invoiced in dollars, which to an extent is inevitable — but not entirely so



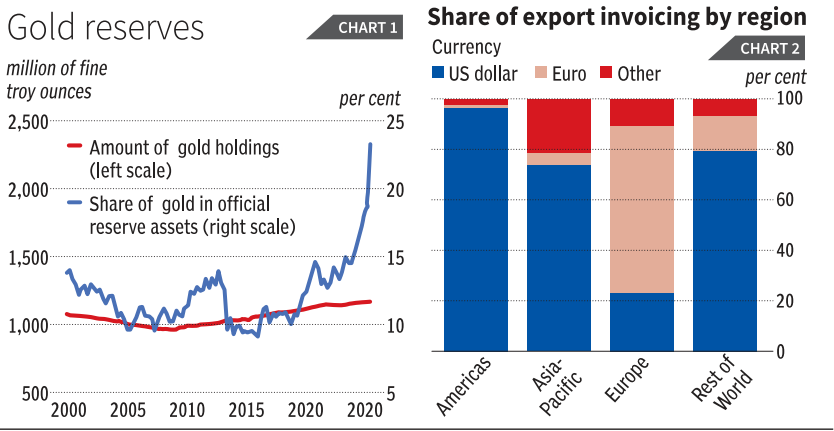
SAUMITRA BHADURI
SHUBHAM ANAND

The rupee was Asia’s worst-performing currency last calendar year, depreciating by more than 6 per cent against the dollar (nearly 10 per cent in FY26). This is striking because India was simultaneously the fastest-growing major economy in the world. A currency does not usually weaken when an economy is thriving. When it does, the explanation lies not at home but abroad, in the workings of the global dollar system itself.

And that system has rarely looked more powerful. The dollar enters the second half of 2026 as the world’s best-performing major currency, lifted by expectations of Fed rate hikes and record inflows into US assets. Yet beneath this strength lies a deeper, more contradictory shift, one that explains why the rupee’s pain has a global address.

CREDIBILITY GAP
A single number captures the dollar’s position today. Its international usage index stands at around 65, against a US share of global GDP of 26 per cent and global trade of 13 per cent. This means the dollar’s financial footprint is more than double its economic footprint. Meanwhile, China’s currency usage index barely registers at 3-4, despite accounting for 17 per cent of global GDP and 13 per cent of global trade. The euro area is the only case where the three measures are roughly in balance. In other words, the world does not have a dollar problem. It has a renminbi credibility problem. Capital controls, geopolitical risk, and shallow bond markets make it structurally unsuitable at scale. The dollar’s dominance, then, is not a choice but a constraint.

THE HEDGE AND THE TRAP
Yet quietly, in the one place where countries do have discretion, something is shifting. The dollar’s share of global foreign exchange reserves has fallen from 57 per cent in 2016 to roughly 40 per cent by end-2025, with gold now accounting for 24 per cent of total



reserves. The headline looks dramatic. The reality is more revealing. Chart 1 reveals a striking divergence. Physical gold holdings have barely moved over 25 years, rising less than 12 per cent, yet gold’s share of reserves has surged from 10 per cent to 24 per cent since 2022, almost entirely on price. What does this imply? Central banks are not buying gold; they are holding what they have while letting its share drift higher. The 2022 inflection is not accidental. It marks the year the G7 froze Russia’s \$300 billion in reserves, weaponising the dollar-based system against a sovereign state. Put another way, central banks are not diversifying because the dollar is weakening. They are hedging against the risk that it could be turned against them. This is the paradox at present. The dollar’s slow loss of share as a store of value is structural; its current strength is cyclical, driven by rate expectations and an AI-fuelled rush into US assets. Both are true at once. If the reserve story is about slow hedging, the transactions story is about immediate, unavoidable exposure. And this is where India’s position is most uncomfortable. Chart 2 shows export invoicing by region. The Americas invoice close to 97 per cent in dollars, Asia-Pacific 74 per cent, and the RoW 79 per cent. The Asia-Pacific number deserves more scrutiny: China is the largest trading partner for most economies here, yet the renminbi barely registers in invoicing. This implies that Asian economies, including India, are paying a dollar tax on trade increasingly conducted with a non-dollar partner. What does this mean for India? Given its trade composition — heavily weighted toward commodity imports, capital goods, and dollar-denominated external debt — its effective dollar invoicing exposure sits closer to the RoW average of 79 per cent than the Asia-Pacific 74 per cent. The RBI built up a record net-short dollar forward book of around \$110-115 billion this year, and reserves fell more than \$46 billion from their February peak. Those numbers, of course, are not a sign of mismanagement. They are the arithmetic of being locked into a dollar-invoiced trading system when global dollar liquidity tightens. But what does India’s reserve buffer actually represent? Unlike China, Japan, or Korea, whose reserves were built on persistent export surpluses, India’s reserves of \$682.3 billion represent accumulated confidence of foreign investors and lenders. That confidence is valuable, but also reversible. When the scramble begins, every stress event forces countries to reach for the same currency simultaneously. Diversifying reserves offers no relief when dollars are still needed to pay every bill.

Reducing gold imports, diversifying exports beyond IT services, prioritising energy sovereignty and cultivating stable non-debt sources of foreign currency are the urgent steps needed

PATH FORWARD
Reserves are larger today and the banking system more resilient than

Food sovereignty: Lessons from France and India

For ensuring that future generation of farmers don’t leave farming, state support and credit access are crucial

Rohini Rangachari Karnik

France is Europe’s largest agricultural producer, accounting for around 18 per cent of the European Union’s total agricultural output. Worryingly, half of France’s farmers are set to exit farming by 2030. Similarly, in India, where about 60 per cent of the arable land is used for agriculture, the youth are leaving agriculture for cities.

Both countries face a shared challenge: how do they ensure generational renewal in agriculture and what does this mean for their respective notions of sovereignty?

The issue of generational renewal of agriculture facing France and India is not only one of production or supply. It is also a question of control: who decides what agricultural commodities are grown, how these are grown and on what terms. It is useful to distinguish food security from agricultural sovereignty. Food security is about reliable access to sufficient, safe and affordable food; agricultural sovereignty is about a country’s ability to control the inputs, institutions and decisions that shape its agricultural future.

In economic terms, the latter is the ability of a nation to control its core production inputs, pricing exposure and long-term soil capital without structural

external dependency. Agriculture sovereignty, more recently known as food sovereignty, rests on six principles — right to food for people, valuing food providers, localising food systems, putting control locally, building knowledge and skills and working with nature. Food sovereignty defends the interests and inclusion of the next generation in agriculture.

Recognising the need for placing food sovereignty at the heart of the political priorities of French agricultural laws, in 2024 France proposed a draft Orientation law on ‘agricultural sovereignty and generational renewal in agriculture’. This law explicitly links sovereignty to training, EU co-financing, fosters education across agriculture, encourages environmental practices, and invests in human resources in keeping with Europe’s aim to double the share of young and new farmers by 2040.

India had its own expression of the food sovereignty movement during recent farm law protests against three farm laws passed by the Centre in which farmers demanded control over markets, inputs and land. The three laws, primarily marketing reforms, were aimed at deregulating food price control, liberalising the control of food stocks and trade, and giving private enterprise more freedom to contract with farmers directly.

One fear of the farmers was that the



FARMING. For future generations RAO GN

minimum support price would get dismantled leaving farmers to bargain directly with a few large corporations. The farmer protests to retain market, input and seed control in India stand in sharp contrast to France’s top-down model of generational renewal, where state policy and explicit financial support, plays an important role in driving entry and retention in farming.

FRANCE’S EXPERIENCES
In France the state lowers financial and bureaucratic barriers for young farmers, as many leave agriculture early due to costs and low incomes. In India, generational renewal as a policy is less explicit, left vulnerable to the needs of small and marginal landholders, high debt, small landholdings, and rural-urban migration. France uses the EU’s CAP Strategic Plan, which includes direct payments,

eco-schemes and transition support for sustainable farming and generational renewal. India’s main tools for agriculture include the Minimum Support Price, input subsidies, PM-KISAN, the Kisan Credit Card scheme, crop insurance, soil-health and irrigation schemes, and market reforms, amongst others. These are major schemes aimed at enhancing productivity, income support and sustainable practices, but with little direct relevance tackling the issue of generational renewal in agriculture.

France’s model shows how legislation and finance can institutionalise generational renewal. The path forward lies in a purposeful synthesis: Indian policy could integrate France’s institutional tools — youth-support schemes, land-access instruments and targeted credit — while France could adopt India’s low-cost agro-ecological community led models that give importance to smallholders and seed sovereignty.

Only by combining state capacity with a sensitivity to movement-driven demands can both countries ensure that the next generation of farmers not only enters agriculture, but does so in terms that are economically viable, ecologically sustainable and politically empowering.

The writer teaches French at the Alliance française de Delhi

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

The e-trucks charge
Apropos, ‘A roadmap for electric trucks’ (July 2). India’s persistent dependence on imported crude oil remains a strategic and economic liability, with the diesel-intensive freight sector accounting for a significant share of petroleum consumption. Expediting the adoption of electric trucks is therefore an economic imperative, not merely an environmental objective. The government must accelerate charging infrastructure, incentivise domestic battery production, and facilitate affordable financing. A robust transition to electric freight transport will curtail oil imports, strengthen energy security, improve

logistics efficiency, and reinforce India’s long-term economic resilience.
N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

This refers to ‘A roadmap for electric trucks’ (July 2), which correctly identifies the chicken-and-egg problem holding back truck electrification. Charging operators will not invest without guaranteed volume, and fleet operators will not commit without reliable charging. The proposed solution, using long-term power auctions to lock in low tariffs for charging hubs, seems sensible and deserves quick implementation.

Government-anchored demand through public procurement and toll incentives for electric freight carriers could also break the deadlock faster than subsidies alone. Further delay will only add to the strain on oil imports on the external account.
Swathi Senthilkumar
Coimbatore

Govt’s regulatory caution
This is with reference to ‘Govt asks Meta to pause WhatsApp user name rollout over fraud risks’. The government’s concerns about WhatsApp’s proposed username feature are not necessarily unwarranted, given the risk of impersonation and phishing.

At the same time, the feature offers privacy benefits by allowing users to communicate without sharing their phone numbers. The overall fraud risk will depend on how effectively Meta prevents deceptive usernames and detects abuse. The government’s review is a precautionary step.
PV Prakash
Mumbai

El Nino disruption
Apropos ‘Super El Nino threat, unseen since 1950 taking shape’ (July 2). June passed without any significant rainfall, heightening the anxiety of farmers, particularly those in the plantation sector, who depend on annual crops but lack a

corresponding debt repayment mechanism during years of crop failure. The coffee sector has faced a double blow this year due to inadequate blossom showers and backing showers. The concerned Ministry should extend timely financial relief to growers by deferring both interest payments and loan repayments on plantation credit. It should also consider waiving interest, as growers’ finances have been severely affected not only by the poor monsoon but also by the disruptions arising from the West Asia crisis.
Rajiv Magal
Halekere Village (Karnataka)



QUICKLY.

PACL refunds ₹3,720 cr till May 5 to 37.5 lakh people



Mumbai: Refunds to investors in the PACL case have crossed ₹3,720 crore, with the Justice (retd) RM Lodha Committee disbursing money to more than 35.74 lakh applications as the recovery process gathers pace through property auctions. The committee has refunded ₹3,720.67 crore to 35,74,401 applications as on May 5, 2026. Since the previous update placed before the SEBI board in September 2025, it has disbursed an additional ₹2,557.67 crore to 13,58,269 applicants. The PACL case dates back to August 2014 when SEBI held that PACL's land investment schemes were unregistered collective investment schemes under the SEBI Act and directed it to wind up the schemes and refund investors within three months. **OUR BUREAU**

CSM Technologies ends 5% lower after flat listing

Bengaluru: CSM Technologies made a flat stock market debut on Thursday, listing at ₹113 per share on both the NSE and BSE, matching its IPO offer price. The stock ended at ₹107.35 on the exchanges, falling 5 per cent to hit the lower circuit. The muted listing came after the company's initial public offering was subscribed 1.36 times. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth, Swastika Investmart, said that the company has shown steady revenue growth, earnings remain volatile and the IPO was priced at a premium valuation of 31x P/E compared to peers. "We maintain a Neutral view, with aggressive investors considering it for the long term," Nyati added. **OUR BUREAU**

SBI Funds eyeing launch of \$1.2 billion IPO in mid-July

Bloomberg

SBI Funds Management is set to launch its initial public offering, which could raise up to \$1.2 billion (₹11,500 crore), in the week starting July 13, according to people familiar with the matter, testing investor demand ahead of a busy pipeline of billion-dollar listings. The country's largest asset manager plans to seek a valuation of ₹1.15 lakh crore (₹12.1 billion) to ₹1.20 lakh crore, lower than the \$14 billion to \$15 billion planned previously, the people said, asking not to be identified. After a subdued first half, India's primary market is gearing up for a wave of billion-dollar-plus offerings, with issuers including Jio Platforms, NSE and Manipal Health Enterprises expected to seek listings in the coming months. SBI Funds' publicly traded

Ratnadeep Retail files IPO papers to raise ₹400 crore

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Ratnadeep Retail, with presence across Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka, has filed its Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP) with SEBI to raise funds through an initial public offering (IPO). According to the DRHP, the proposed IPO of the Hyderabad-based firm is a combination of a issue of shares aggregating up to ₹400 crore and an offer for sale of up to 1,48,60,000 shares by the promoter selling shareholders. Sandeep Agarwal, Manish Bhartiya, Mitesh Bhartiya, Yash Agarwal and Kavita Agarwal are the promoters of the company. Ratnadeep Retail proposes to utilise ₹40 crore from the net proceeds of the issue towards repayment/prepayment of loan facilities, ₹260 crore for setting up of stores under the Ratnadeep and National Mart formats.

SEBI to seek fees in rupees from FPIs

NO TO DOLLAR. Move aims to simplify registration of foreign investors, eliminate manual reconciliation issues

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India has decided to shift the payment of registration and related fees by foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) and foreign venture capital investors (FVCIs) from US dollars to rupees, with the changes set to be implemented within six months of the notification. Fees will be specified in rupee terms, while FPIs and FVCIs will continue to pay the equivalent amount in eligible foreign exchange to their Designated Depository Participant (DDP).

FEE PAYMENT The DDP will, in turn, remit the amount to SEBI in rupees within five working days of granting registration. The six-month implementation

period has been provided to enable changes to systems and processes required for the transition from dollar-based payments. The registration fee for category-I FPIs and FVCIs will be ₹2.3 lakh, instead of \$2,500, while Category-II FPIs will pay ₹23,000 (\$250). Renewal fees will similarly shift to ₹2.3 lakh for category-I FPIs and ₹23,000 for category-II FPIs from the existing \$2,500 and \$250. The FVCI renewal fee will be ₹9,000 instead of \$100. During FY26, SEBI collected \$12.99 million or ₹115.98 crore through FPI and FVCI registration, continuation and other related fees. The changes are aimed to be revenue neutral for SEBI based on fee collections during FY26. Currently, custodians remit fees only during the first five days of every month, meaning any fee due after



ON BALANCE. The changes are aimed to be revenue neutral for SEBI based on the fee collected during FY26

5th till end of month, is only paid in the subsequent month leading to opportunity cost for SEBI.

RIGOROUS PROCESS Fees received in USD have to be manually accounted in the SAP Portal of SEBI and invoices for the same have to be prepared manually. This manual process is time consuming and lacks real time accounting visibility, leading to delays in financial reporting. In several cases charges

during remittance of USD and the subsequent conversion charges are deducted from the fees received in the ICICI Bank account, thereby resulting in shortfall in fee received and discrepancies during reconciliation. Further, identification of the corresponding FPI/FVCI and the services for which fees are paid involves co-ordination between relevant departments of SEBI for reconciliation of data is a rigorous process that consumes

Carlsberg files confidential IPO papers, to raise ₹7,100 cr

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Danish brewer Carlsberg A/S learnt to have filed papers confidentiality with the market regulator SEBI for tapping the primary market. One of the largest brewers in India, Carlsberg will join the growing multinationals tapping the vibrant Indian market. The confidential route allows companies to keep their IPO filings private until it is cleared by SEBI. This allows the company to withhold sensitive trade information from public glare. Some large Indian companies such as Jio Platforms

and NSE also took the confidential route for filings with SEBI. The IPO of Carlsberg will largely be an offer for sale with the promoters offloading part of their stake to raise about \$750 million (₹7,100 crore), sources said. With the equity markets set to rebound in the second half of this year, the company may attempt to complete the IPO by this year, he added. Earlier, share sale of multinational companies such as Hyundai Motor and LG Electronics saw good response despite higher valuations. Carlsberg India, which entered India in 2007, commands a market share of 22 per cent.

Zee fund infusion: Brokers upbeat but proxy firms sceptical

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Brokerages have shown a level of confidence in Zee Entertainment Enterprises' recent warrants issue proposal despite proxy firms forecasting the same investor response as last year. The board of Zee approved the issuance of around 24.94 crore fully convertible warrants on Wednesday at ₹126 a warrant aggregating to ₹3,143.5 crore on a preferential basis to promoter group entity Sun-bright Mauritius Investments. Zee proposed for about 25 per cent of the issue price or ₹31.5 per warrant to be paid

upfront. This means Zee will get ₹785.9 crore immediately, bringing total cash balance to ₹3,545.4 crore. Last year, investors turned down a similar proposal of the company to issue warrants worth ₹2,237.4 crore to promoters. Yet, analysts have voiced optimism in Zee's approval this time around. "Promoters currently own 4 per cent in Zee. Once all the warrants get converted into equity, promoter holding will rise to 23.8 per cent. "Increasing skin in the game can be a big confidence booster," said Jinesh Joshi, Vice-President, Research Associate, Institutional Research – PL Capital, in a research note. The funds raised from the

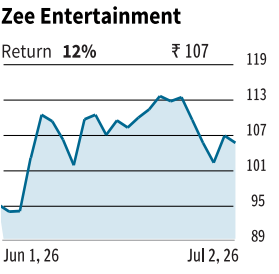
proposal could go towards acquiring further sports properties after acquiring FIFA and German football league Bundesliga. **GROWTH PLANS** It could also expand its micro-drama format or invest in the OTT platform Zee, as per the brokerage. Noting that Zee managed on 60 per cent of the votes in favour of the proposal in 2025, as against the required super majority of 75 per cent, Joshi said, "It would be interesting to see, if the shareholder approval is achieved this time." Similarly, Nuvama Institutional Equities also voiced confidence in Zee's second attempt at preferential allot-

IT sector helps markets to gain for second straight day

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets extended gains for a second straight session on Thursday, with a dramatic rebound in technology stocks stealing the show after four consecutive days of sharp selling, even as global tech indices faced headwinds from AI-driven jitters and chip stock sell-offs across Asia. The Nifty 50 closed at 24,175.70, up 0.71 per cent, while the Sensex gained 0.75 per cent to settle at 77,502. The Nifty IT index surged 4.64 per cent — its biggest single-session recovery in recent weeks — driven by short covering and value buying ahead of first-quarter earnings. The India VIX dropped sharply to 12.29. "After a brutal four-day slide, the IT sector came back," noted Sarvam Goel, Founder, Pocketful, adding that "as global investors ro-

tate out of expensive AI and semiconductor stocks, Indian IT services seem to be catching some of that diverted capital as a comparatively lower valued alternative." The Nifty Midcap 100 rose 0.48 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 advanced 1.25 per cent, with advances outnumbering declines roughly 2:1. Auto and realty also posted healthy gains, supported partly by strong June passenger vehicle sales, which rose 24 per cent y-o-y. However, Nifty Bank ended nearly flat. The reopening of the Strait of Hormuz eased energy supply concerns, pulling Brent crude below \$71 per barrel. Domestically, healthy June GST collections and strong UPI transactions have signalled sustained economic momentum. Japan's commitment of over \$10 billion investments across AI, defence technology and energy security also added to positive sentiment.



ment of warrants when speaking to media. However, proxy firms think otherwise. InGovern Research still forecasts the proposal to meet the same fate as last year. With Zee's overall structure largely unchanged, investor reservations on warrants issue to promoter groups remain unaddressed,

said Shriram Subramanian, Founder, InGovern. "Investors will not agree to the 25 per cent upfront payment of the issue price. This is a failed exercise," said Subramanian. Similarly, IiAS maintained its reservations on promoter group getting warrants. It asked the government to explain what has changed since last year and the extent of dilution. "IiAS is generally not in favour of preferential issue of warrants to promoters because of the risk of forfeiture. IiAS does not encourage warrants to promoters and rather all the money be brought-in upfront," said IiAS in its voting guidelines to investors.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

COAL INDIA (ADD) Target: ₹475 CMP: ₹438.70 Coal India's Jun-26 production declined 1 per cent y-o-y to 57 mt, reflecting comfortable inventory (14 days vs long-term average of 13). However, inventories have already declined 22 per cent YTD, and we expect production to improve from H2-FY27 as seasonal disruptions recede. We forecast output to increase from 768mt in FY26 to 815/850mt in FY27/28 (about 6 per cent CAGR), supported by 6-7 per cent power demand growth, stronger thermal generation and electricity consumption, and tighter seaborne coal markets following Indonesia's production target cut to 600mt for CY26 (790 mt in CY25). Offtake stood at 65.8mt (down 1.3 per cent m-o-m and 7.5 per cent y-o-y), driven by strong dispatches from CCL and ECL, translating into an estimated 783 mt for FY27 (up 5.3 per cent y-o-y) vs 744mt in FY26. The seasonal demand pickup and potential El Niño impact reinforce our constructive FY27 demand outlook. However, the continued rise in renewables (26.7 per cent of the power mix vs 25.0 per cent a year ago) remains a structural headwind to incremental thermal coal demand. With additional support from a reduction in Indonesia's coal production target to 600 mt in CY26 vs 790mt in CY25, rising renewable penetration remains a structural headwind over the long term. We believe near-term demand and supply dynamics remain supportive. We maintain Add with TP of ₹475.

Yes Securities

TATA MOTORS PV (ADD) Target: ₹405 CMP: ₹346 The launch of Sierra EV at premium pricing depicts Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles' strategy of rather than competing purely on affordability, it is slowly shifting focus towards a technology and performance-led positioning supported by extensive features and a lifetime battery warranty. While the pricing versus rivals appears to be higher, we believe the premium is largely justified by the product's differentiated appeal. In line with Harrier EV, it expects the Sierra to have 30-40 per cent powertrain mix. This should strengthen Tata's brand perception in premium EVs and support margins over the medium term. Early customer acceptance and sustained production ramp-up will remain key monitorable, particularly as competition intensifies across the ₹18-26 lakh EV SUV category. As shared in its recent investor day, TMPV expect the Indian PV industry is expected to grow to about 6.4 million units by FY31, driven by steady 6-7 per cent CAGR, with SUVs contributing over 60 per cent of volumes and rising alternative fuel adoption pushing EV and CNG penetration beyond 45 per cent. Within this backdrop, TMPV aims to significantly outperform with 2x volume growth to over 1.2 million units and around 20 per cent market share, supported by an expanded 15-nameplate portfolio, higher addressable market coverage, and strong traction in SUVs, EVs, and CNG. Our consol EPS remained unchanged as we maintain Add with SOTP based TP of ₹405 (unchanged).

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

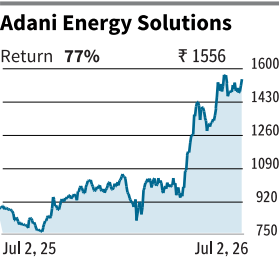
TODAY'S PICK.

Adani Energy Solutions (₹1,556.50): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl_research_bureau

The stock of Adani Energy Solutions has been steadily rallying since the beginning of April. However, since early June, it has largely been sideways, oscillating between ₹1,460 and ₹1,600.

The chart shows that the scrip has formed a good base at ₹1,460 and on the back of this, it rose in the last couple of sessions, indicating that the bulls are gaining traction. We expect the stock to gather good strength and soon break out of the barrier at ₹1,600. Once this occurs, the price can rise to ₹1,720 in the near-term. Therefore, traders can



long now at ₹1,556 and buy more shares at ₹1,460. Place initial stop-loss at ₹1,420. When the price touches ₹1,620 and ₹1,680, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,550 and ₹1,630 respectively. Book profits at ₹1,720. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24270 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
24130	23950	24350	24500	The contract has risen above a hurdle. Buy with stop-loss at 24100.

₹796 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
792	778	806	820	The stock is stuck in a range; refrain from opening fresh trades.

₹1041 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1030	1000	1075	1100	The rally might extend; go long now with a stop-loss at 1020.

₹289 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
285	278	292	295	The stock might stay flat intraday; do not initiate new positions.

₹235 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
230	227	237	243	Go long if the stock breaks out of 237; keep a stop-loss at 230.

₹1303 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1290	1260	1312	1330	Buy if the stock surpasses 1312; stop-loss can be at 1290.

₹1051 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1020	1000	1055	1075	Go long if the stock declines to 1040; place stop-loss at 1000.

₹2067 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2055	2020	2080	2150	Buy the stock if it moves above 2080; keep a stop-loss at 2050.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 169.85 pts.
	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Infosys	1040.90	42.58	14.33	3.30	
ICICI Bank	1400.00	31.60	17.33	9.06	
TCS	2068.10	19.96	15.13	1.91	
HCL Tech	1078.10	10.11	17.57	1.03	
M&M	3175.40	8.85	21.20	2.56	
Tech Mahindra	1421.30	8.20	28.99	0.82	
Titan	4481.10	7.44	78.40	1.67	
Bajaj Finserv	1855.70	7.34	15.10	0.97	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1066.70	5.69	25.04	1.35	
Adani Ports	1883.20	5.64	33.94	1.25	
Hind Unilever	2210.60	5.54	49.08	1.77	
Tata Steel	187.67	4.51	21.52	1.40	
State Bank	1051.60	3.79	11.20	3.93	
Eicher Motors	7250.00	3.34	36.08	0.90	
Hindalco	949.20	3.00	15.93	1.24	
Asian Paints	2744.50	2.77	59.90	1.12	
Bharti Airtel	1875.00	2.66	33.78	5.15	
Wipro	174.00	2.42	13.78	0.45	
Grasim Ind	3169.20	2.37	20.94	1.08	
TataConsumerProduct	1107.20	2.32	70.84	0.65	
Int'lGlobeVai	5444.00	2.22	0.00	1.11	
Coal India	438.90	2.17	8.71	0.95	
Adani Enter	3171.20	2.14	41.54	0.74	
UltraTech Cement	11536.00	2.07	41.52	1.23	
Bajaj Finance	1018.40	2.05	32.80	2.47	
Trent Ltd.	3317.80	2.00	102.78	1.00	
Apollo Hosp	8696.00	1.74	62.44	0.81	
JSW Steel	1223.80	1.56	11.73	1.04	
Sun Pharma	1871.00	1.11	39.01	1.79	
ONGC	235.96	0.82	5.96	0.53	
Dr Reddys Lab	1345.70	0.77	27.02	0.74	
PowerGrid Corp	288.20	0.64	16.83	1.18	
Bajaj Auto	9657.00	0.36	26.05	0.99	
NTPC	358.25	0.30	12.61	1.53	
HDFC Life	571.35	0.33	64.47	0.56	
Eternal Ltd	279.70	0.00	737.19	1.83	
Cipla	1456.00	-0.09	30.46	0.74	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	239.73	-0.20	101.41	0.71	
SBI Life	1784.40	-0.64	72.46	0.72	
HDFC Bank	795.90	-0.84	15.47	11.01	
ITC	289.90	-0.84	17.28	2.52	
Tata Motors PV	345.95	-0.84	4246.92	0.85	
Bharat Elec	415.05	-0.94	50.05	1.34	
NestleIndia	1446.20	-1.19	79.70	0.94	
Maruti Suzuki	14348.00	-1.34	20.73	1.69	
Kotak Bank	399.30	-1.85	20.59	2.66	
Max Healthcare	1127.40	-2.03	76.07	0.76	
Axis Bank	1362.60	-3.83	15.96	3.53	
Reliance Ind	1393.50	-6.54	18.42	7.54	
L&T	4059.40	-8.49	29.46	4.29	

▲ Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▲ 317.90 pts.

	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3626.80	91.39	54.07	3.45
Tata Motors Cv	440.50	55.37	53.57	3.72
Divs Lab	6682.50	51.01	69.08	3.44
Godrej Consumer	1077.20	39.56	59.21	1.75
Britannia Ind	5374.00	38.65	51.02	2.56
Bpcl	310.45	37.11	5.21	2.55
LtIntimtree	3680.70	36.46	21.91	1.38
Adani Energy Solutions .	1556.90	34.15	78.16	2.07
PidlIntll	1605.40	21.33	66.13	2.01
AdaniGreenenergy	1555.20	19.84	128.92	2.11
Indian Oilcorp	141.62	19.59	4.58	2.14
Bosch	41515.00	18.55	44.15	1.46
Ambuja Cements	428.95	18.45	19.39	1.08
United Spirits .	1373.40	18.17	53.51	1.64
DIF	658.20	17.85	36.91	1.71
Bajaj Holdings	10658.00	17.63	12.24	1.90
Jindal Steel	1043.80	16.28	31.68	1.56
Hyundai Motor India .	1950.70	13.53	29.18	1.13
Shree Cement	26220.00	11.75	54.10	1.42
Macrotech Developers .	1006.20	11.30	29.30	1.13
Muthootfin	2949.70	10.93	11.16	1.28
Hdfc Amc	2759.60	8.24	41.39	2.28
Torvent Pharma	4651.40	6.33	73.79	1.98
Hindus Zinc	528.70	6.06	16.15	1.33
Siemens	3580.40	5.10	83.18	1.28
Indian Hotels Co .	720.70	5.02	45.65	2.56
Tata Power	376.40	4.64	23.50	2.54
Mazagon Dock	2555.00	4.30	37.40	0.79
Canara Bank	126.64	3.54	6.43	1.72
Solar Industries	1788.50	3.50	97.23	3.13
Vedanta	276.10	2.73	6.81	1.89
Samvardhoshersoninternatl	147.59	1.04	38.13	2.64
Hindustanaeronautics	4434.00	0.22	32.53	3.40
Reliance	174.29	-1.66	15.12	1.90
Infra Ecl	369.60	-1.83	5.97	1.87
Indian Railway Finance Corp	90.83	-2.06	16.94	0.74
Shree Finance	43.05	-2.99	4.22	2.53
Union Bank	174.35	-3.00	6.85	1.36
Chall Natl Bank	96.91	-6.36	6.65	1.49
Indiabulls	1099.80	-6.89	42.53	0.11
Capita	356.30	-7.74	30.92	0.73
Polysar	6861.00	-11.68	92.01	1.46
Polandamalamn&Fin	1788.50	-18.76	29.14	1.13
Ren Beverages .	510.65	-20.23	53.82	2.82
Adaniems Energy India .	3549.50	-23.40	96.51	1.27
Amrinder	925.45	-28.08	33.38	3.77
Power & Ind Sol	33.44	-33.44	0.00	0.05
Power & Ind Sol	244.90	-34.35	126.26	0.66
Om Of Baroda	260.25	-61.96	6.71	1.95
Genesyspur	4187.00	-66.85	91.95	2.73

QUICKLY.

IBM allots a quantum computer for Amaravati



Hyderabad: In a major boost to Andhra Pradesh, IBM Chairman and CEO Arvind Krishna has confirmed that Amaravati will host one of the first two IBM Quantum Computers in India, with commissioning targeted for September 2026. He said the availability of talent is one of the reasons for setting up the computer there. **OUR BUREAU**

BoB reports 15% increase in global business

Mumbai: Bank of Baroda (BoB) reported a 15.46 per cent y-o-y increase in global business (deposits plus advances from domestic and overseas operations) in the first quarter of FY27 to ₹30,51,218 crore as at June-end 2026. Domestic deposits increased by 14.74 per cent to ₹13,81,822 crore as at June-end 2026. Domestic advances rose 16.14 per cent to ₹11,51,383 crore. **OUR BUREAU**

Delhi HC upholds 2010 ruling, says RTI Act applies to NSE

KEY VERDICT. Says National Stock Exchange satisfies definition of ‘public authority’

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



ESTABLISHED JUDGMENT. After hearing the arguments, a division bench of the High Court said that the judgment of the single judge does not call for interference **REUTERS**

After 16 years, a Division Bench of the Delhi High Court upheld the ruling of a single Bench that the Right to Information (RTI) Act applies to the National Stock Exchange of India (NSEI).

In an April 15, 2010 ruling, Justice Sanjiv Khanna had said: “It is held that the petitioner is a ‘public authority’ as it is an ‘authority or institution of self-government’ constituted or established by notification or order issued by the appropriate government.”

Further, it is also held that the petitioner is controlled by the appropriate government. The writ petition accordingly has no merit and is dismissed, it said of NSE’s petition.

NSE’S APPEAL

After hearing all the arguments and examination of the facts presented, a Division Bench of Justices C Hari Shankar and Om Prakash

Shukla said that the judgment of the single judge does not call for interference.

It also agreed with the said ruling that, though the order under Section 4(3) of the SCRA (Securities Contracts Regulation Act) was issued by SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India), it had to be treated as an order of the Central government, as SEBI was acting, while issuing the order, as a delegatee of the Central government under Section 29 of the SCRA.

“The learned single judge is, therefore, correct in his

view that the National Stock Exchange of India would qualify as a ‘public authority’ not only under the second part, but also under the first part of Section 2(h) of the RTI Act,” the Division Bench said.

It highlighted some portions of the single judge’s ruling that “NSEI qualifies as an ‘authority or body’.”

Further, the words “established or constituted”, especially the word “constituted”, would include a case in which the body, though established by a private party, required recognition for

functioning as a stock exchange.

Further, the order issued by SEBI under Section 4(3) of the SCRA, which was essential for NSEI to function, had to be regarded as an order issued by the Central government in view of Section 29 of the SCRA, the Single Judge bench ruling said.

“We see no reason to differ. It has to be remembered that this is not a case in which the body was established as a private company and was regulated by statute later, which is what Thalappalam (Supreme Court ruling in Thalappalam Service Cooperative Bank Limited vs State of Kerala), referred to. It is a case where, without recognition by SEBI, the NSEI could not function as a stock exchange at all.

“Therefore, the NSEI also satisfies the first part of the definition of ‘public authority,” the Division Bench said and affirmed and upheld the judgment of the Single Judge. Accordingly, the appeal was dismissed.

Rupee external debt surges 10.6 percentage points over 15 years

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

India’s external debt profile has undergone a notable shift over the past decade and a half, with the share of rupee-denominated liabilities rising by 10.6 percentage points.

DATA FOCUS.

Analysis of the data from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA) shows that rupee-denominated debt accounted for 29.4 per cent of India’s external debt at the end of March 2026, compared with 18.8 per cent at the end of March 2011.

RUPEE DEBT

The composition of India’s external debt has evolved over the years. Foreign currency-denominated debt declined from 81.2 per cent in FY11 to 70.6 per cent in FY26. Even so, FY26 marked a departure from the recent trend, with the rupee denominated debt slipping 1.7 percentage points over the year.

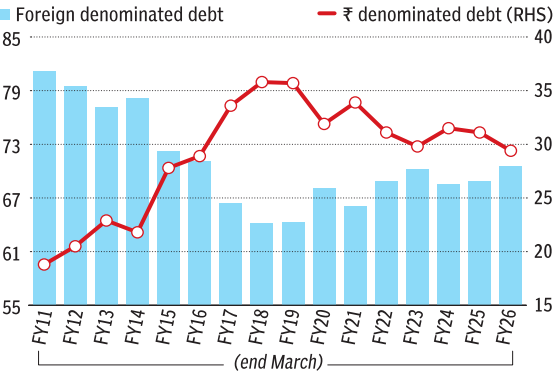
Within rupee-denominated liabilities, foreign portfolio investors’ (FPI) debt investments declined to \$72.8 billion in March 2026 from \$77.8 billion in March 2025.

Balances in non-resident (external) rupee accounts (NR(E)RA) also edged down to \$98.6 billion from \$100.7 billion. In contrast, non-resident ordinary (NRO) deposits continued to expand, rising to \$33.3 billion in FY26 from \$31.1 billion in FY25. Smaller categories such as rupee debt related to defence and civilian obligations continued to decline.

In FY26, the decline of \$5 billion in FPI debt holdings and \$2 billion in NR(E)RA balances outweighed the \$2.2 billion increase in NRO

External debt metrics

The share of ₹ denominated debt is increasing over the longer term



But the share of ₹ denominated debt fell in FY26 by 1.7 percentage points

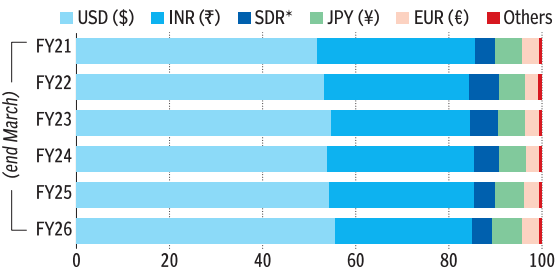
Share of (in %)	FY25 (end March)	FY26 (end March)	Change (in pp)
Foreign denominated debt	68.9	70.6	1.7
₹ denominated debt	31.1	29.4	-1.7

Rupee debt dominated by FPI debt investments and NRI deposits

Categories of ₹ denominated debt instruments (in \$ million)

Items	Mar 2024 R	Mar 2025 PR	Mar 2026 P
FPIs - debt investment	61,538	77,809	72,794
NR(E)RA	98,624	1,00,733	98,564
NRO	27,522	31,135	33,334
Rupee debt - defence	808	766	697
Rupee debt - civilian	44	40	34
Others	22,162	18,543	18,830

The dominance of \$ in India’s external debt mix gets stronger



Source: RBI, DEA

*Special drawing rights

deposits, leading to a fall in overall rupee denominated liabilities, even as India’s gross external debt increased to \$762.7 billion in FY26 from \$736.4 billion in FY25.

DOLLAR STRENGTHENS

The US dollar, however, remained the dominant cur-

rency in India’s external debt and further increased its share in FY26.

Although the RBI has managed to contain the overall external debt as a per cent of GDP to a manageable level, the dominance of dollar-denominated liabilities, poses a challenge.

Chance AI bets on visual agents to power next AI wave

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Singapore-based Chance AI is expanding its presence in India, one of its fastest-growing user bases, as it looks to establish a new category of AI “visual agents” built around camera-first interactions rather than text prompts.

“We felt a missing category between visual search and chatbot — something that doesn’t just identify objects or answer questions, but helps users understand why something matters.

Chance AI is a visual agent, not just a camera tool or a search-identified app,” said Founder and CEO Dr Xi Zeng.

The visual agent is built for real-life lifestyle scenarios, not productivity. He added that the next important AI interface begins with vision since it is the most intuitive operating system for humans, and not typing.

VISUALLY NATIVE

The ex-ByteDance and OnePlus executive shared that Chance AI had seen strong attraction among younger, visually native



Xi Zeng, CEO, Chance AI

users, especially in North America and India.

It supports 17 languages, including Hindi since India is the third-biggest community for the company.

“India matters because it’s one of the most mobile-first, visually native, and young user-heavy markets in the world. That makes it a strong environment for a product like ours, which depends on camera-first behaviour and real-life usage scenarios. We don’t see India as just a big market but as one of the places where a new AI habit could emerge fastest,” the CEO shared.

North America accounts for 35-40 per cent of Chance AI’s users, followed by Europe at 25 per cent and India at 20 per cent. Some of Chance AI’s use cases in-

clude travel, shopping, fashion, everyday learning, artworks, landmarks and installations. However, translation is not a key feature for the platform, as this productivity use case is already addressed by Google Lens. “A wearable device is the next step, depending on the maturity of the hardware. We can build a visual reasoning layer and be prepared for the next generation of AI hardware,” Xi said.

He said enterprise adoption is part of the company’s long-term strategy, but its immediate focus is on growing its consumer business.

Project Samridhi bolsters HPCL as earnings increase by ₹1,691 cr in FY26

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

State-run Hindustan Petroleum Corporation’s (HPCL) company-wide EBITDA improvement programme, Project Samridhi, aided the oil marketing company (OMC) in increasing earnings by \$0.54 per barrel across its entire marketing volume, or roughly ₹1,691 crore.

The OMC with the third largest market share in the country, operating more than 25,100 retail outlets (ROs), recorded an over 13 per cent y-o-y growth in sales (including exports) to 51.45 million tonnes (mt) in FY26.

In an interaction with *businessline*, HPCL CFO K Vinod said that Project Samridhi is a structured, corporation-wide EBITDA improvement programme designed to strengthen the refiner’s profitability and long-term competitiveness while safeguarding operational performance, product



K Vinod, CFO, HPCL

quality and safety.

“In FY26, Samridhi not only met its target but also exceeded it, with total accruals of the order of ₹1,691 crore, a meaningful part of which is permanent in nature and now built into the corporation’s cost base,” he said.

HPCL had set a target of improving EBITDA by \$0.50 per barrel across its sales volume for the last financial year.

Launched in May 2025 to counter sustained cost and margin pressures faced by the refining and marketing business, Project Samridhi

was conceived to move beyond isolated, one-time cost-saving measures and establish a permanent, governance-led framework for identifying and capturing value across the organisation.

THREE PILLARS

The programme focuses on three key pillars — margin improvement, cost reduction and structural process transformation.

By driving cost leadership, enhancing operational efficiencies and embedding a culture of continuous improvement, the programme aims to deliver sustainable value creation rather than short-term savings, Vinod said.

The total EBITDA improvement comprised ₹744 crore in recurring benefits and ₹947 crore in one-time benefits. In refinery operations, the programme delivered savings of ₹428 per tonne of crude throughput across 26.04 mt processed,

equivalent to \$0.66 per barrel.

In the marketing business, savings of ₹ 119 per tonne of sales volume across 48.53 mt sold translated into an impact of \$0.18 per barrel.

Besides, the cost-take-out initiatives contributed ₹288 crore, while the margin improvements initiatives delivered ₹1,403 crore. Contribution from margin improvement items was majorly delivered through a combination of various initiatives such as crude value maximisation, refinery efficiency improvements, supply optimisation, logistics efficiencies, and strategic commercial interventions.

“Major learnings that have emerged are that disciplined execution on a carefully prioritised set of high-impact initiatives yields far more value than spreading effort thinly across a large number of smaller actions,” he said.

Also, that company-wide participation makes a material difference, he added.

In crowded skincare market, Asaya prioritises science-led approach over scale

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Amid a wave of acquisitions and funding in India’s beauty and personal care (BPC) sector, skincare start-up Asaya is betting that scientific research, not celebrity endorsements or influencer-led marketing, will be its biggest differentiator.

The company, which develops products for hyperpigmentation and other concerns specific to melanin-rich Indian skin, is preparing to raise a Series A round to support its next phase of growth.

Founded by Eeta Sharma, along with Paper Boat’s ex-

founder Neeraj Biyani and Mandeep Singh Bhatia, Asaya has grown five-fold over the past year, with its user base crossing 5 lakh customers. The company has raised ₹43 crore to date and plans to deploy fresh capital towards expanding its research and development capabilities, clinical validation, product innovation and off-line retail presence.

“Our immediate priority is investing in science,” Sharma told *businessline*.

“The funding will primarily go towards strengthening our R&D capabilities, conducting more clinical studies and launching newer categories before we look at manufacturing.”



Eeti Sharma, Co-Founder, Asaya

BUILDING IP

The start-up is also broadening its portfolio beyond hyperpigmentation serums into adjacent categories, including night creams and products targeting more complex pigmentation concerns. On the distribution

front, quick commerce has emerged as a key growth engine. While Amazon and Nykaa remain its largest online channels, Blinkit already contributes about 17 per cent of revenue.

The expansion comes as India’s BPC industry witnesses heightened consolidation, with larger consumer companies increasingly acquiring or investing in fast-growing D2C brands to tap product innovation and niche consumer categories.

Asaya, however, believes sustained investment in science and clinical validation will be central to building a durable skincare brand rather than simply chasing rapid scale.

Enterprise Connect

Bank of India handed over Dividend cheque for Rs.1,553.50 crore to GOI

Bank of India handed over dividend cheque dated 17th June 2026 of Rs.1,553.50 crore for the financial year 2025-26 to Government of India on 30th June, 2026. The dividend cheque

was presented to Hon'ble Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman in the presence of Smt. Shalini Pandit, Joint Secretary, DFS by Shri Rajneesh Karnatak, Managing Director & CEO and all the four Executive Directors of Bank of India. Bank of India had declared dividend of Rs.4.65 per equity share (46.50%) for the financial year 2025-26. For the full year 2025-26, Bank of India's net profit jumped by 14.19%, which went up from Rs. 9,219 crore in FY25 to Rs. 10,527 crore for FY26. By successfully paying dividends to the Government of India, Bank of India reaffirms its robust financial performance and unwavering dedication to creating value for its shareholders. This accomplishment stands as a testament to the bank's commitment to excellence and its ability to generate consistent returns.

KEEL laying ceremony of 4th ship of next generation offshore patrol vessels (06 NGOPVs)

Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd (MDL), a Navratna DPSU, achieved the milestone of Keel Laying of 4th ship of NGOPVs(Y-16404) for Indian Coast Guard on 25 Jun 2026. DIG Vivek Sharma, PD(TS), CGHQ presided the Keel laying

ceremony at Nhava Yard, MDL in the presence of Mr. Rajiv Ranjan Kumar, Executive Director (Production- MDL) along with senior officials from ICG, Classification society (ABS & IRS) and MDL. MDL has signed the contract with ICG to design, build, and deliver Six (06) Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels. The project is valued at Rs 1614.89 crores. Each vessel is fitted with twin Controllable Pitch Propellers driven by Diesel Engines to meet contractual speed and shall be classified under Dual Class (ABS & IRS). The vessels will be designed as High-Speed Craft under Class HSC rules. The vessel shall be used primarily for Coastal and Offshore Patrolling and Policing Maritime zones of India. The primary role also includes Fisheries Protection, Anti-Smuggling and Anti-Piracy, Search and Rescue operations, Ocean Surveillance and Monitoring of Sea lines of communication (SLOCs).

Vikram Kumar Appointed as Chairman & Managing Director of MSETCL

Senior IAS officer Vikram Kumar has assumed charge as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Limited (MSETCL), Maharashtra's state-owned power transmission utility. A 2004 batch IAS officer of the Maharashtra cadre, Vikram Kumar brings with him over two decades of administrative experience across urban governance, infrastructure development, industrial growth and public administration. Prior to joining MSETCL, he served as Additional Metropolitan Commissioner-I at the Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority, a position he held since March 2024. An architect by qualification (B.Arch), Vikram Kumar has held several key positions in the Maharashtra Government. He served as Municipal Commissioner of the Pune Municipal Corporation from July 2020 to March 2024 and earlier as Metropolitan Commissioner of the Pune Metropolitan Region Development Authority. His previous assignments also include Chief Executive Officer of the Maharashtra Maritime Board, Joint Chief Executive Officer of the Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation, Collector of Chhtrapati Sambhajnagar and Sindhudurg districts, Municipal Commissioner of the Mira Bhayandar Municipal Corporation and Chief Executive Officer of Zilla Parishad, Washim.



Debt Angels Hosts “Debt. Set. Grow.” — Bridging India’s Lending Ecosystem



Debt Angels, a curated platform connecting lenders and borrowers, successfully hosted its flagship networking event Debt. Set. Grow. at the MCA Club, Boundary Hall. The event brought together over 35 leading financial institutions, NBFCs, real estate funds, and growth-stage enterprises for a morning of meaningful dialogue and deal-making. Held from 10:30 a.m. to 2:30 p.m. and followed by a networking lunch, the event created a high-trust environment where capital providers and capital seekers could connect directly. The format blended structured deal showcases with open networking, complemented by a panel discussion featuring industry experts offering insights into the current lending landscape and evolving borrower needs. Participating organisations spanned India's financial ecosystem — bringing together prominent lenders, NBFCs, and borrowers from sectors including real estate, infrastructure, and allied industries. The panel discussion was moderated by Deepak Maheshwari, Founder of Debt Angels, and featured Ujjwal Parekh (LIC Fund), Vishal Pawar (Maa Pranaam), and Pooja Sikka (Aditya Birla Capital) — bringing together perspectives from across the lending and borrowing spectrum. Debt. Set. Grow. reflects a growing appetite for curated, relationship-first platforms that go beyond transactional deal-making — building an ecosystem where capital finds its purpose and businesses find their growth partner.

KRIBHCO Sponsored & Organized Yonex Sunrise Gujarat State Badminton Championship 2026



KRIBHCO has been actively engaging in a variety of events to encourage sports and recreational activities among local industries, nearby villages and communities on a consistent basis. This year also KRIBHCO Surat took the lead in organizing the Yonex Sunrise Gujarat State Badminton Championship 2026, which took place from 23rd to 28th June 2026 at Staff Club, KRIBHCO Township, Hazira, Surat. The event featured competitions for both male and female players across various categories, including singles, doubles, and mixed doubles. The championship concluded successfully on 28th June 2026. A total of 183 participants from across Gujarat took part in five different events during the tournament, including state, national & International-level players, marking a significant achievement for KRIBHCO. The winners were presented awards in front of senior officials of KRIBHCO, Surat District Badminton Association.

QUICKLY.

Tech Mahindra acquires
Alyis for ₹2.21 crore



Mumbai: Tech Mahindra on Wednesday acquired Brazilian-based IT services firm Alyis Serviços Técnicos LTDA for ₹2.21 crore as part of its partnership with Orange Business via its wholly-owned subsidiary. Alyis was newly incorporated in Petropolis, State of Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, on May 27 and holds about 270 employees and has operations in Brazil supporting the LATAM region. **OUR BUREAU**

Tiger Analytics to set up
AI delivery centre in Patna

Chennai: US-based Tiger Analytics, an AI and advanced analytics company, has announced plans to set up an AI Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Patna, Bihar. The centre will act as an AI delivery hub that empowers local talent to build advanced enterprise AI solutions for global Fortune 1,000 companies. Tiger Analytics, which has a significant presence in Chennai, has committed an investment of ₹12 crore for the centre that will have a team of 200. **OUR BUREAU**

Vinay Vaidya is Flipkart's
Senior V-P for tech

Bengaluru: Flipkart has appointed former Tata Digital Chief Technology Officer Vinay Vaidya as Senior Vice-President for technology, as the e-commerce major strengthens its leadership team to build AI-driven supply chain and marketplace capabilities. He will lead technology and platform development, while driving innovation in logistics and AI-powered capabilities, the company said on Thursday. **OUR BUREAU**

Visa unveils payment
passkey in India

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

Digital payment authentication must move beyond passwords and one-time passwords (OTPs) as AI-driven commerce gathers pace, a top Visa official said on Thursday. “Authentication cannot remain dependent on passwords or one-time codes designed for an earlier digital era. It must become secured by design, invisible to the consumer, and resilient against increasingly sophisticated fraud,” Suresh Sethi, Group Country Manager for India and South Asia for Visa, said.

The payments major launched its ‘payment passkey’ solution in India. This enables consumers to authenticate online card payments using capabilities already built into their mobile devices, and helps satisfy the two-factor authentication requirement in India.

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No. P1-3515/2026/2633 Date: 24/06/2026
e-Tender Notice
e-Tenders are invited through www.etenders.kerala.gov.in for the printing of bar code/QR code and variable data as an offline system with rate per label on contract basis. Due date is **15.07.2026**. For more details, please visit our website www.kbps.kerala.gov.in or contact over phone 0484-2422343/ 9656909994.
Sd/- Managing Director

**TATA POWER**
(Corporate Contracts Department)
The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)
The **Tata Power Company Limited** invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai.
1) OLA for Hiring of DG Set Hiring Services for Mumbai Distribution (RefCC27AS014)
2) OLA for Supply of 11KV & 22KV Oil filled DTs for Mumbai Distribution (RefCC27AS016)
3) Supply of 22KV/25kV KARMU for Mumbai Distribution (Ref CC27AS017)
4) OLA for supply of HDPE pipes for Mumbai Distribution (RefCC27AAM015)
For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Interested bidders to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter along with Complete Bid Document by **17:00 Hrs, Friday, 24th July 2026**
Also, all future corrigendum's (if any), to the above tender will be informed on website <https://www.tatapower.com> only.

‘Lack of deep-tech ecosystem deprives start-ups of ₹1 lakh cr research fund’

CAPITAL CRUNCH. PM-EAC member Neelkanth Mishra acknowledges challenges to risk capital access in India

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The absence of a deep-tech ecosystem in India hinders attempts to provide the ₹1 lakh crore Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) fund to deserving start-ups, according to Neelkanth Mishra, Member of the Prime Minister’s Economic Advisory Council, during a fireside chat at the Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) event.

Speaking at the launch of the AI Council of India in Mumbai, Mishra acknowledged the challenges to risk capital access in India, extending the same to the disbursement of the government’s flagship deep-tech financing initiative.

“We can’t deploy the money we have. There are



We can’t deploy the money we have. There are good people, but it’s not enough to absorb that ₹1 lakh crore

NEELKANTH MISHRA,
Member, Prime Minister’s Economic Advisory Council



good people, but it’s not enough to absorb that ₹1 lakh crore,” said Mishra, who sits on the RDI fund’s second-level fund manager selection committee.

DEEP-TECH SHORTFALL
He attributed this shortfall to a deep-tech ecosystem that is yet to mature, creating a gap between venture capitalists (VCs) and quali-

fied start-ups that deserve financial support.

Despite the risk appetite among start-ups, VCs have no visibility into the deep-tech community or its benefits in terms of RoI, resulting in more investment flowing into better understood ventures like e-commerce.

Taking the example of chip designers, Mishra said, “I notice that there are chip

design companies coming up in India. Some of these companies require \$100 million, \$400 million, or more to develop. [But] that ecosystem doesn’t exist.

Our venture capitalists are still building that muscle, the ability to understand which founder is faking it and which is real.”

When asked to list one constraint that matters most to India’s AI future, Mishra listed capital as well as talent.

He attributed the ‘brain drain’ in India’s talent pool to a lack of opportunities and proper compensation.

“If they want to do cutting edge work, they have to go outside. It’s also about money. We can’t afford to pay them,” said Mishra, urging the community to accelerate the build-up of the risk capital universe, to stop the brain drain.

Further, he asked India to focus on building a intended research ecosystem.

“The moment you have high-quality research happening, the confidence of venture capitalists who invest in Indian start-ups will begin to grow as of now, unfortunately we do not have cutting edge research and especially,” he said.

From a global perspective, Mishra pointed out the US to be leading in risk capital, possibly 10 years ahead of India. At the same time, he noted that China, despite its state-directed investment has “already lost the race.”

Overall, Mishra was optimistic of India’s ecosystem evolving over the next few years allowing start-ups easier access to much-needed funds for start-ups, encouraging institutions like IIT to act as feeder points for funding.

Adani Enterprises launches ₹10,000-cr QIP

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Adani Enterprises Ltd on Thursday launched its ₹10,000-crore qualified institutional placement (QIP), setting a floor price of ₹3,034.68 per equity share for the issue, a discount of 4.5 per cent from its Thursday’s closing price of ₹3,177.50, as the flagship

Adani Group company looks to fund expansion projects, pare debt and pursue acquisitions.

According to the preliminary placement document filed with stock exchanges, it plans to utilise the net pro-

ceeds to fund capital expenditure at subsidiaries, including setting up a polyvinyl chloride plant and payment of the concession fee for the six-lane Chennai Outer Ring Road tolling, operation, maintenance and transfer project.

INORGANIC GROWTH

The proceeds will also be used to repay or prepay outstanding borrowings of Adani Enterprises and its subsidiaries, including Mun-dra Solar PV Ltd, Adani Airport Holdings Ltd and Kutch Copper Ltd, besides funding inorganic growth through acquisitions and investments.

Lightstorm’s subsea cable to link India’s East Coast to Malaysia and Singapore

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai



● LANDMARK DEAL

Plugging the cable into the larger grid can power and connect over 80 data centres across Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata, Mumbai, Delhi and Bengaluru

Lightstorm announced a multi-million dollar deal to launch a new 12-fiber-pair subsea network that directly connects India, Singapore and Malaysia with consortium partners Microsoft, Singtel and Tata Communications.

The I-2SEA submarine cable system, expected to be up and running by the end of 2029, I-2SEA will be among the earliest next-generation systems to come online on the India-Singapore route.

GROWING DEMAND

The system will be designed specifically for AI, cloud, and hyperscale workloads and deliver one of the lowest-latency routes between Singapore and Hyderabad, supporting the growing demand for AI training.

“Based on whether you’re calculating from the East or West Coast up to Singapore or Malaysia, the latencies with this cable will be about 10-15 per cent lower than any other cable that is currently [running in this Asean route],” Amajit Gupta, Group CEO and Managing Director, Lightstorm, told *businessline*.

The company projects the Singapore-Hyderabad network to be 10-15 per cent faster and the Singapore - Mumbai connectivity to be 15 per cent faster when using Lightstorm’s network in India.

As the project spans approximately 3,600 km with four landings stations, I-2SEA is one of the largest single subsea project in India in recent times.

Plugging the cable into the larger grid can power and connect over 80 data centres across Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata, Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru and others at “super low speeds,” said Gupta.

FOUR STATIONS

The project plots four landing stations, two of which will be at Machilipatnam and south Chennai and integrated into Lightstorm’s 30,000 km terrestrial network, extending connectivity into over 80 data centres across India. Further, direct high-capacity connectivity between India, Singapore and Malaysia will be increasingly strategic for regional digital growth, as per Microsoft.

The system utilises optimal route planning combined with a deep cable burial strategy that targets three-metre depth across the entire network for the buried sections. This gives the I-2SEA cable system high level of protection and high uptime.

Aside from the four major players, the I-2SEA system is being developed under a Joint Build Agreement with NEC Corporation as the system supplier and ACPL (Continent Pte Ltd) as the marine installation partner and Telecom Malaysia will act as the landing partner in Malaysia.

Geojit Financial Services Ltd.

Reg.Office: 34/659-P, Civil Line Road, Padivattom, Kochi, Kerala - 682024
CIN: L67120KL1994PLC008403,
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NOTICE OF 32ND ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND OTHER RELATED INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that the 32nd Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Members of the Company will be held on Friday, 24th July, 2026 at 4.00 p.m. through Video Conferencing (VC) / Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM) in compliance with all the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made there under and the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs General Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, Circular No.17/2020 dated April 13, 2020 and Circular No. 20/2020 dated May 05, 2020 along with other applicable Circulars issued by the MCA and SEBI to transact the Businesses as set out in the notice calling the AGM.

The Notice of the 32nd AGM and Annual Report 2025-26 of the Company has been sent only by electronic mode by National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) to those members whose email IDs are registered with the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA) or the Depository Participants (DP).

The copy of the Notice and Annual Report 2025-26 is also available on the Company's website www.geojit.com and the websites of BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and NSE Limited at www.nseindia.com. Members who do not receive the Annual Report may download it from Company's website or may request for a copy of the same by writing to the Company Secretary of the Company at companysecretary@geojit.com or the Company's RTA at coimbatore@in.mpmc.muif.com

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended and Regulation 44 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company is providing its members facility to exercise their right to vote on resolutions proposed to be passed in the AGM of the Company using an electronic voting system from a place other than the venue of the Meeting (remote e-voting) along with option of voting at the AGM by e-voting. The Company has engaged the services of NSDL to provide e-voting facility.

The Company has appointed Mr. Satheesh Kumar N, M/s Satheesh and Remesh, Practicing Company Secretaries as Scrutinizer to scrutinize the e-voting process in fair and transparent manner.

The Company has completed dispatch of Notice and Annual Report by email on Thursday, 02nd July 2026 to all members, whose name appears in the Register of Members/Beneficial Owners as on Friday, 26th June, 2026.

The remote e-voting shall commence on Tuesday, 21st July, 2026, at 09.00 A.M. and ends on Thursday, 23rd July, 2026 at 05.00 P.M. (IST). The remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time. A person, whose name appears in the Register of Members/Beneficial Owners as on the cut-off date of Friday, 17th July, 2026 only, shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting as well as e-voting at the Meeting. The members who cast their vote by remote e-voting may attend the Meeting through VC/OAVM Facility but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again through the e-voting system during the Meeting. Members participating in the 32nd AGM and who had not cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be entitled to cast their votes through e-Voting system during the AGM. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by a Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.

Any person, who becomes member of the Company after dispatch of Notice of AGM and holding shares as on the cut-off date of Friday, 17th July, 2026, may obtain the user id and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com. If a person is already registered with NSDL for e-voting the existing user ID and password can be used for casting vote.

In case of any queries/grievances, you may refer the Frequently Asked Question (FAQ) for shareholders and e-voting user manual for shareholders available at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com>. Members facing any technical issue in login before / during the AGM can contact NSDL helpdesk or Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, NSDL, 301, 3rd Floor, Naman Chambers, Plot C-32, G-Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 051 or by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or call at 022 - 4886 7000.

For Geojit Financial Services Ltd
Sd/-
Liju K Johnson
Company Secretary

Place: Kochi
Date: 03.07.2026



THANGAMAYIL JEWELLERY LIMITED

Regd. Office: 124, Nethaji Road, Madurai – 625001.
Corp. Office – 25/6, Palami Centre, New Natham Road, Madurai – 625014.
Phone: 0452 – 2565553; Website: www.thangamayil.com;
Email: companysecretary@thangamayil.com
CIN: L36911TN2000PLC044514

NOTICE OF 26TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

Notice is hereby given that the 26th Annual General Meeting (AGM) for the year ended 31st March, 2026 of the members of Thangamayil Jewellery Limited (the Company) is scheduled to be held on Wednesday, 29th July, 2026, at 11.30 AM at Chamber of Commerce, No.178 B, Kamarajar Salai, Madurai – 625009 to transact the business as stated in the notice sent to the members individually. The Annual Report including the notice of the Annual General Meeting, Directors' Report, Corporate Governance Report, Management Discussion and Analysis Report and Audited Accounts of the Company for the financial year ended 31st March 2026 is sent to the email-ids of the Shareholders whose email-id is registered with the Company / depositary participants and the same is also posted on the website of the Company, www.thangamayil.com.

As per Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) rules, 2014 as amended and Regulation 44 (1) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 the Company is pleased to provide its members the facility to cast their vote by Electronic means on all resolutions set forth in the notice. The Register of Members and Share Transfer Books of the Company shall be closed from 23rd July, 2026 to 29th July, 2026 (Both days inclusive) for the purpose of Annual General Meeting (AGM).

Notes:

- The business may be transacted through voting by electronic means – E-voting.
- The date and time of commencement of remote E-voting: 26th July, 2026 – 10 AM.
- The date and time of end of remote E-voting : 28th July, 2026 – 5.00 PM
- Cut - off date: 22nd July, 2026.
- Any person who acquires Shares of the Company and becomes Member of the Company after dispatch of notice and holding Shares as on cut - off date i.e. 22nd July, 2026 may obtain the login id and password by sending a request at helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or to the RTA M/s. MUFG Intime India Private Limited at email id coimbatore@in.mpmc.muif.com or contacting them at address as mentioned in the notice of Annual General meeting.

(f) The Members may note that:

- Remote E-voting shall not be allowed beyond 28th July, 2026 – 05.00 PM.
- The facility for E-Voting shall be made available at the Annual General Meeting and the Members attending the meeting who have not cast their vote by remote E-voting shall be able to exercise their right at the meeting through E-voting.
- A Member may participate in the Annual General Meeting even after exercising his / her right to vote through remote E-voting but shall not be allowed to vote again in the meeting ; and
- A person whose name is recorded in the Register of Members or in the Register of beneficial owners maintained by the Depositories as on the cut-off date only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote E-voting as well as voting in the Annual General Meeting

(g) Website address of the Company where 26th Annual Report 2025-2026 along with notice of the meeting is displayed at www.thangamayil.com

(h) It is strongly recommended not to share your password with any other person and take utmost care to keep it confidential.

(i) The Board of Directors of the Company have appointed Mr.S.Muthuraju, Practicing Company Secretary as a scrutinizier to scrutinize the E-voting process.

(j) Kindly note that once you have cast your vote you cannot modify or vote at the Annual General Meeting.

(k) The Results of E-voting will be announced by the Company on its website and also communicated to the Stock Exchanges within the prescribed time limits after the Annual General Meeting.

(l) Name, Designation, Address, Email ID and phone number of the person responsible to address the grievances connected with facility for voting by electronic means: CS.K. Narayanan, Company Secretary, emailID: companysecretary@thangamayil.com, phone no: 0452 – 2565553, address: Corp. Office – 25/6, Palami centre, New Natham road, Madurai – 625014.

For Thangamayil Jewellery Limited
SD/-
CS K.Narayanan
Company Secretary

Place: Madurai
Date: 03-07-2026

